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Aerial View



Green Courtyard



Clubhouse



Outdoor Area



Heated Swimming Pool

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Vedapatti, Coimbatore

2 & 3 BHK RETIREMENT HOMES ₹1.1 Cr onwards

TYPE	SIZE (SQ.FT.)	PRICE RANGE
2 BHK	1484	₹1.11 Cr
3 BHK	1986	₹1.44 Cr

WORLD-CLASS AMENITIES & FEATURES

CURATED LIFESTYLE AMENITIES

- Heated swimming pool
- Modern kitchen & dining pavilion
- Clubhouse with lounge
- Gym
- Mini-theatre
- Yoga deck
- Indoor games
- Library
- Walking track
- Guest suites

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- 4.5 ft. wide door
- AI powered fall detection sensor*
- Intelligent vital monitoring system*
- Nurse call system in all units
- Beveled interior walls for safety
- Grab bars in washrooms & common areas
- Ground level frameless doors
- Motion sensor lighting

- All units & common areas - wheelchair & stretcher-friendly
- Bathroom doors opening outwards

365 DAYS OF THOUGHTFUL SERVICES

- Nutritious & gourmet meals
- Daily housekeeping
- Concierge & helpdesk
- Ayurvedic therapies
- Physiotherapy
- 24x7 in-house nursing team & ambulance service
- Periodic doctor visits & hospital tie-ups
- Inhouse salon & spa
- 24x7 security, repair & maintenance services
- Laundry & ironing
- Community walks, guided tours
- Thrive hive-to pursue what you love

*Add-on features

LOCATION MAP



LOCATION ADVANTAGES

Perur Temple	– 1.5 km	Brookefields	– 9 km
Vadavalli	– 5 km	Marudamalai	– 10 km
R.S. Puram	– 7 km	Isha Yoga Centre	– 25 km

HEALTHCARE

ANP Nursing Home	– 8 km	Royal Care, Gandhipuram	– 10 km
KG Hospital	– 9 km	GEM Hospital	– 12 km
Ganga Hospital	– 10 km	Ramakrishna Hospital	– 13 km
Kongunad Hospital	– 10 km		

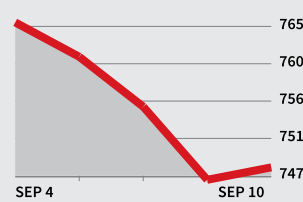
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IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23477.80	+46.30
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.84	+0.03
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.30	+0.20
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	152673.00	-198
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	233642.00	-1607

SUGAR PRICE CONTROL.

The government will track sugar production on a monthly basis from October to keep prices in check **p10**



HERO'S LEAP.

Hero Motors Ltd is seeking a valuation of about ₹3,815 crore in its ₹1,000 crore IPO **p7**

QUICKLY.

GLOBAL PHENOMENON
Liquidity concerns after CAS not unique: SEBI



Mumbai: Liquidity concerns following the introduction of the closing auction session (CAS) are not unique to India, and global jurisdictions had also faced lower liquidity in the initial phases of implementation, said Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, Securities and Exchange Board of India. He was speaking on the sidelines of the Global Fintech Fest in Mumbai on Thursday. **p2**

OFFER SIZE DOWN
SBI, BoB, insurers trim stake in NSE IPO

Mumbai: Several major shareholders of the National Stock Exchange (NSE) have sharply reduced the number of shares they plan to sell in the exchange's IPO, bringing the offer size down to 12.4 crore shares from 14.89 crore proposed earlier. The revised offer would represent around 5.1-5.2 per cent of NSE's equity compared with 6 per cent earlier. **p6**

FCNR(B) liquidity to take 3-4 months to deploy: SBI chief

MONEY MATTERS. Banking system flush with ₹10.50 lakh crore as on September 9

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Banks are unlikely to immediately deploy the funds generated through FCNR(B) deposits, with the process expected to take another three-four months, according to Challa Sreenivasulu Setty, Chairman of State Bank of India (SBI).

"I think everybody will be more responsible. It will take about three-four months for the deployment of the liquidity. I don't think it will happen within the next month," said Setty on the sidelines of the Global Fintech Festival 2026.

SURPLUS LIQUIDITY

The comments come at a time when the banking system is flush with liquidity. RBI data showed that surplus liquidity in the system stood at ₹10.50 lakh crore as on September 9. The surplus has largely been driven by banks mobilising \$127.23 billion under the RBI's special FCNR(B) deposit mobilisation window between June 8 and August 31. Echoing the

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- FCNR(B) inflows of \$127 b create 'problem of plenty' for banks
- Excess liquidity raises near-term negative carry concerns
- Abnormal lending risks emerge
- RBI may wait for GST, advance tax outflows before liquidity action



need for caution, Amitabh Chaudhry, MD and CEO of Axis Bank, warned that the large FCNR(B)-linked inflows could encourage aggressive lending as banks look to deploy excess funds. "FCNR could lead to some abnormal lending because we will have to deploy this. I hope they don't do that," he said, urging banks to maintain underwriting discipline.

CREDIT DEMAND

At the same time, the SBI management maintained that credit demand remains robust. Ashwini Kumar Tewari, MD, SBI, had said that

the bank's loan pipeline remains strong. "Overall, if you include the undisbursed term loans, unutilised working capital and pipeline, it exceeds ₹9 lakh crore. So, there is a strong pipeline for corporate credit."

Sanjay Agarwal of CareEdge Ratings said corporate credit demand should remain supportive of liquidity absorption. "Corporates are going to banks rather than the markets because market rates are high. That's one reason why credit growth remains strong and should help in deploying the additional FCNR(B) liquidity,"

Food safety regulator widens crackdown to dark stores, cloud kitchens, trademarks

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) is widening its enforcement drive, moving beyond conventional food-safety inspections to scrutinising the rapidly expanding quick-commerce and cloud-kitchen ecosystem, while simultaneously tightening the rules around how packaged food is marketed and described to consumers.

The food safety regulator has also asked States to ramp up surveillance, especially of dairy products, ahead of the upcoming festival season. The FSSAI, which has been pulling up packaged food companies over misleading labels and claims, has written to the Office of the Con-

troller-General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks to not register brand trademarks containing terms such as 'healthy'.

INVOLVING STATES

Rajit Punhani, CEO, FSSAI, told *businessline*: "We are strongly focussing on dark stores and cloud kitchens to ensure that they comply with hygiene practices and maintain adequate cold-chain infrastructure. In fact, we have called a meeting with States later this month, to discuss issues related to dark stores and cloud kitchens."

Asked about the ongoing matter related to the front-of-the-pack warning labels before the Supreme Court, he said the judgment is awaited. The FSSAI, along with State FDAs, has intensified enforcement action over

the past few months, including pulling up packaged food companies for misleading labels and claims. "More than 100 companies have changed their labels. Some companies said that 'healthy' is part of their trademark. So, we have written to the Controller General of Trademarks that they should not register trademarks with terms such as 'healthy'," said Punhani.

RAIDS CONDUCTED

Between April 1 and August 31, food safety enforcement agencies across India conducted 7.05 lakh inspections, 13,203 raids and issued 8,151 notices to food business operators for food safety related violations. This led to suspension of 677 food licences and 105 food registrations, besides seizure of 35.48 lakh kg and 86,921 litres of food products, with a reported value of ₹42.01 crore.

"More than 600 people have been arrested in the last six months over violations. Prosecutions are equally important and State officials are being sensitised about speedy disposal of cases," he added. State Food Safety Commissioners and FDAs have been directed to focus on enforcement while stepping up recruitment of food safety officers, he noted.

SC questions regulator on warning labels

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday questioned the FSSAI on how it proposes to determine whether packaged foods were 'high' in sugar, salt or fat as part of its proposed front-of-pack warning labels, as it underlined that food safety

was a cause of 'national interest'. The food safety regulator had last month proposed prominent red warning labels on packaged foods high in added fat, added sugar or salt, in a regulatory pivot after the top court questioned its reluctance to introduce such warnings.

see p12

BRICS diplomacy: Modi set for bilateral meetings with Xi, Putin during summit

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The economic and strategic significance of the BRICS summit in Delhi on September 12-13 became clear on Thursday with the confirmation of Chinese President Xi Jinping's first visit to India in seven years and a bilateral meeting between Russian President Vladimir Putin and Prime Minister Narendra Modi scheduled a day ahead of the summit.

RUSSIAN PARLEYS

Russian Trade Minister Anton Alikhanov is already in Delhi, holding talks with his counterpart Piyush Goyal during the India-Russia Business Dialogue, while other delegates had started arriv-



ing by late Thursday. PM Modi was effusive on social media, putting a welcome message on X: "All set for BRICS 2026".

Goyal said India needed to diversify exports to Russia — pharmaceuticals, engineering goods, chemicals, food and marine products and auto components — to help lift bilateral trade to \$100 billion by 2030 from around

\$60 billion in FY26. He noted that Russia remains a major importer of several product categories where India is a significant global exporter, yet has not fully tapped that potential.

BORDER ISSUES

More crucial meetings lie ahead. "The Modi-Xi talks are expected to focus on the fragile improvement in ties, with the unresolved border issue, widening trade imbalance, visa problems and curbs on Chinese investment likely to dominate," a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

Both sides have sought to stabilise relations since the 2020 Galwan clashes, but mutual distrust and border friction continue to limit economic engagement des-

pite periodic exchanges, the source said. In the Modi-Putin bilateral on Friday, India will be pushing for greater exports to Russia to narrow a bilateral trade deficit exceeding \$50 billion.

"Modi's meetings with Xi, Putin and other BRICS leaders will be watched closely as nations navigate uncertainty from Washington's shifting tariff and trade policies under President Donald Trump," the source said.

DEFENCE DEALS

Putin is expected to press ahead on defence deals, including the proposed co-production of Su-57 fifth-generation stealth fighter jet and on alternative payment mechanisms within BRICS. With China, the border remains the core obstacle.

is doing it with a bit of premium," said Faisal Ka-woosa, Founder, Techarc. iPhone Duo's pricing may not impact sales prospects too much, given the unparalleled storytelling power of Apple, he added.

ASPIRATIONAL VALUE

Rishi Padhi, Principal Analyst at Gartner (India), said Apple has "a definite aspirational value" when it comes to iPhones and other hardware. "That interest will remain strong, although higher prices could eventually weigh on volumes."

For the decidedly premium/ultra-premium offerings, financing schemes will determine how consumers react.

Tarun Pathak, Research Director, Counterpoint, said many will bookmark the device as a potential purchase and the iPhone Duo will expand the overall foldable category in India.



TAKING THE EXTRA MILE. Diehard loyalists plan to get their hands on the device either in the US or Dubai **REUTERS**

to be under ₹2.5 lakh. "But I think waiting and buying from the US makes more sense than buying it in India now," he said. The India pricing also makes Samsung foldable looks more affordable now, he added.

FLEX PRODUCT

N Nagaraj, a tech professional based in Chennai, who has used foldables earlier, views the Duo as a 'flex product' that people

carry to make a statement at that price point. "I would prefer not to buy the very first generation product and watch how it fares," he said.

Apple, on its part, seems to be testing how much its brand pull can withstand the stiff price.

"Apple has seen a price resilience in India. While other brands are increasing prices to adjust memory cost pressures alone, Apple

A Monk Who Trades



DID YOU KNOW?

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Satcom calling

Finally, a policy framework for satellite broadband

The Digital Communications Commission’s (DCC) decision to approve a 5 per cent spectrum usage charge on adjusted gross revenue (AGR) for satellite communication operators is an important step towards finally bringing satellite broadband to India. The Centre has taken nearly two years to put the key elements of a policy framework in place. It should now move with urgency to translate the decision into actual services.



The approved 5 per cent AGR-linked spectrum charge is one percentage point higher than the 4 per cent recommended by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI). However, operators serving government-notified hard-to-connect areas such as border regions, hilly terrain and islands will effectively pay 4 per cent. Spectrum will be assigned administratively, rather than auctioned, for five years, with a two-year extension. The decision is welcome because satellite communications are fundamentally different from terrestrial mobile networks. Satellites can share spectrum across large geographical areas and do not require the dense, dedicated infrastructure that terrestrial networks need. An auction could have fragmented spectrum access and imposed costs on an emerging industry.

The need for satcom in India is compelling. Fibre and mobile towers are difficult and expensive to deploy in large parts of the country, including mountains, islands, border areas and sparsely populated rural regions. Low-earth-orbit constellations can provide high-capacity connectivity with substantially lower latency than traditional geostationary satellites. Satcom can also provide backhaul for terrestrial operators where fibre is not viable, making satellite and mobile networks complementary technologies. India now has several serious players waiting to launch satellite broadband services including Elon Musk’s Starlink, Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb and Jio Satellite Communications.

The DCC deserves credit for rejecting TRAI’s proposal for an additional ₹500 annual charge per subscriber in urban areas. The proposal was aimed at preventing satellite operators from concentrating on lucrative urban customers. But satcom capacity itself imposes a natural constraint on how much business satellite networks can do in densely populated cities. It makes more economic and technological sense to let operators decide where their limited capacity is most valuable. However, the government should reconsider another TRAI recommendation that it has rejected: subsidising satellite user terminals in unserved and underserved rural areas. The biggest obstacle to satcom adoption in precisely those areas where it has the greatest value may not be spectrum pricing but the upfront cost of equipment. TRAI had noted that satellite terminals can cost ₹20,000-₹50,000 and proposed support through direct benefit transfers or the Digital Bharat Nidhi. The decision needs a relook, at least until smartphones and other consumer devices that can directly receive satellite broadband become widely available.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



POINT
BLANK.



LOKESHWARRI SK

The rivalry between the two major Indian stock exchanges — the BSE and the NSE — is stuff legends are made of. While the former boasts of a 150-year history and beginning under a banyan tree in British India, the latter appeared as a technically savvy whiz kid in early nineties, to sweep stock trading from trading rings to computer terminals with the introduction of satellite-based trading network.

NSE’s entry not only improved the reach and penetration of stock trading, but it also ushered in transparency, thus greatly weakening the stronghold of stockbrokers who were ruling over Dalal Street for more than a century. NSE also made the most of the first-mover advantage in launching pan-India online trading, to capture lion’s share in both cash and derivatives trading in equities. It’s no wonder that there is no love lost between the two exchanges.

Those watching this rivalry from the fence were greatly amused when BSE had to list its share on the NSE, when it made its stock market debt in 2017. But the glee is much more this time around, with the NSE having to list its share on the BSE, when it finally opens for trading.

HOW DID THIS HAPPEN?

This situation is reminiscent of old Hindi movies where kids would get separated from their parents in fairs or trains and grow up among strangers. Poor BSE and MCX stocks are growing older on other exchanges and now NSE stock is also destined to have the same fate.

The villain of the story is SEBI, the market watchdog, which forbids stock exchanges from listing on themselves. It has laid down in section 45 of the Securities Contracts Regulations, 2018, that “a recognised stock exchange may apply for listing of its securities on any recognised stock exchange, other than itself and its associated stock exchange.”

There are however reasonable grounds for taking this stern stand. One, there is a conflict of interest when a stock exchange facilitates the listing and trading of its own stock. This is because exchanges have to oversee the entire IPO process — take care of the bidding and share allocations and the final listing. When the exchange lists its own share, it could be tempted to tamper with the IPO process.

Two, besides listing, when the share trades on its own parent exchange, there is fear that the exchange may be more lenient in surveillance and allow conducive price movements. There can also be lapses in continuous listing obligations.



BLOOMBERG

Much ado over
NSE listing on BSE

The NSE stock will attract hordes of investors irrespective of the exchange on which it trades

But self-listing is not uncommon globally. Many of the major stock exchanges, including the London Stock Exchange, Nasdaq, Singapore Exchange and Australian Stock Exchange have listed and are trading on their own platforms. But when exchanges self-list, then there are certain guardrails which must be installed.

For instance, the trading of the stock on the parent company’s platform will have to be supervised by the stock market regulator or an independent authority. Similarly, continuous listing obligations will have to be monitored by an independent authority. The Board of the exchange will have to be bolstered with strong independent directors to ensure that there are no corporate governance lapses.

So far, SEBI has stood its ground and held that the risks outweigh benefits in self-listing.

THE MCX PLAYBOOK

Besides BSE, there is one more stock exchange that has cross-listed on other exchanges — the Multicommodity Exchange or MCX.

The intense rivalry between the NSE and MCX is another long-drawn saga, best left for another day. (One would be right in concluding that Indian stock exchanges are quite medieval in their behaviour.) The cut-throat relationship between the two exchanges made MCX

decide to list only on BSE when it made its IPO in 2012. That way, MCX saved its honour by not submitting to NSE’s initial supervision.

But given that the liquidity on the BSE platform is comparatively lower, MCX also allowed its shares to trade on the NSE, but in the permitted to trade (PTT) category. The PTT category allows stocks to trade on an exchange, without a formal listing. The stock must, however, be listed on another exchange.

If we consider the turnover of MCX, the daily average value of MCX shares traded on NSE amount to around ₹800 crore. On the BSE, the daily traded value is less than one-tenth of this.

Based on media reports, NSE appears to be wanting to follow in MCX’s footsteps. That is, list on the BSE and seek permission to trade its shares on its own exchange platform, under the permitted to trade category. The

SEBI forbids stock exchanges from listing on themselves to curb conflicts of interest, ensuring the integrity of the IPO process and prevent lax surveillance over stock price movement

difference, however, is that MCX stock is not trading in the PTT segment of its parent exchange.

WILL SEBI AGREE?

It is to be seen if the market regulator agrees to allow NSE shares to be traded in the PTT category on NSE. If this is allowed, bulk of the trading in the NSE share will be on the NSE platform.

A nod from the regulator for this proposal will however be surprising. This is because stocks in PTT category record as much volume as the regular category. Allowing this will go against the SEBI’s principle of removing conflict of interest in trading of stock exchanges’ shares. SEBI will have take on the responsibility of supervising of the trading of NSE shares on NSE platform, if this is allowed.

While ensuring that trading of NSE shares stays on the NSE platforms may be important for the exchange, investors are unlikely to care where they buy or sell the share. The liquidity on the NSE stock counter is likely to be quite good, above ₹1,500 crore per day, irrespective of the exchange on which it trades. So, price discovery is unlikely to be compromised in the NSE stock counter.

NSE and BSE may perhaps prefer settling the issue with a duel, complete with spears, shields and all. But since we live in more civilised times, they will have to wait for SEBI’s final word.

Are we trapped in a high interest rate cycle?

A rate cut is off the table for now due to unsustainable public debt in the West and forex risks, rupee pressures in India

Sachin Gupta

About three to four years ago, as the global economy reeled from the pandemic’s aftershocks, a new economic mantra emerged: “higher for longer.” Surging US inflation and weakened fiscal positions worldwide underpinned the thesis that ultra-cheap money was over.

Time has vindicated that warning. Rates have not fallen — and the tone has turned more aggressive, with markets now expecting policy rates to climb a further 25-50 basis points over the coming quarters, led by the US Federal Reserve and, maybe, by the Reserve Bank of India, also. The question is no longer about a temporary spike, but a structural one: are we trapped in a high-interest-rate cycle for the long term?

THE GLOBAL CONTEXT

The tremors in international bond markets trace back to an unprecedented expansion of sovereign debt. US national debt recently crossed \$40 trillion, pushing the 10-year Treasury yield toward 4.8 per cent and 30-year



POLICY RATES. Staying high

yields beyond 5.2 per cent. Nor is this only an American story: the UK, Germany, and Japan are each grappling with multi-year or multi-decadal highs in borrowing costs.

Japan’s shift is the most striking — historically the anchor for negative rates, its 10-year bond yield has recently neared 3 per cent, a level last seen three decades ago. Increasingly, long-duration yields worldwide are being set by structural forces rather than central banks’ policy rates.

Five structural pressures are driving this, and yields are unlikely to ease meaningfully until they do:

Persistent fiscal deficits: The US deficit has run near 6 per cent of GDP for

three years, pushing debt past 125 per cent of GDP — a profile closer to an emerging market than the world’s largest developed economy.

Deglobalisation and protectionism: Aggressive trade tariffs are creating a structurally higher floor for inflation.

Escalating defence expenditure: Geopolitical tensions are forcing higher military spending, straining sovereign balance sheets.

Refinancing pressure: Low-yielding, pandemic-era debt is maturing, forcing governments to roll it over at today’s higher rates.

Sticky welfare commitments: Political realities leave governments reluctant to trim social safety nets.

None of this looks likely to reverse soon — which is why optimism about a return to lower rates remains, for now, misplaced.

THE INDIAN OUTLIER

Amid this turbulence, India stands out as a macroeconomic outlier. While developed-market yields spiralled upward, India’s benchmark 10-year G-Sec yield softened slightly over the past three years, settling near 6.95 per cent, reflecting prudent fiscal

management, proactive monetary policy, and relatively benign inflation.

The harder question is whether domestic rates can keep easing independently while developed-market rates stay elevated. The short answer is no: further cuts are constrained by foreign-exchange risk and the need to defend the rupee against a dominant dollar.

India has also seen weaker foreign portfolio inflows as its rate differential with the US narrows. Investors once demanded a premium of 450-500 basis points to hold Indian debt over US Treasuries; that spread has compressed to 200-225 basis points. With this cushion eroded, the RBI has little room to cut further without risking capital outflows and a weaker currency.

The global financial architecture is undergoing a fundamental regime change. Debt accumulation, geopolitical spending, and protectionism have dismantled the old low-rate playbook. A durable softening of interest rates is off the table for the foreseeable future — in India as much as anywhere else.

The writer is Chief Rating Officer & Executive Director at CareEdge Ratings. Views are personal

✉ LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Health worries

This refers to the Editorial ‘Packages of concern’ (September 10). Mandating warning labels on packaged foods can have only a limited impact on dietary habits unless we simultaneously educate people about the harm caused by excessive intake of sugar, salt, and unhealthy fats in ultra-processed packaged foods. For added effectiveness, the proposed red hexagonal sign could be designed with a crisp ‘EatRight’ note merged into it. Further, the two-of-three-ingredients criterion for the warning sign’s applicability appears to be a clear

loophole that needs to be plugged.

Kamal Laddha
Bengaluru

Time to act fast

This refers to ‘Package of concerns’ (September 10), it is troubling that even after the Supreme Court stepped in, our food safety regulator is still delaying clear warnings on unhealthy snacks. The current plan only shows a warning sign if two out of three things, sugar, salt or fat, are too high, which means a product dangerously high in just one of these can still avoid any warning. If countries like Chile and Israel can label junk food clearly, there is no good reason India cannot do the

same. People deserve to know exactly what they are eating, in plain and simple terms, right on the front of the pack.

Veda Chidanand
Bengaluru

Funds inflow

This refers to ‘FCNR(B): Benefits outweigh costs (September 10)’. While the hedging and sterilisation costs appear manageable, the less visible after-effects of these measures also need to be assessed. For example, RBI has taken various measures to absorb excess liquidity through VRRR, which is essentially a short-term measure. Such excess liquidity represents a potential opportunity cost for banks,

as funds absorbed through VRRR cannot be deployed simultaneously for credit. Even if RBI resorts to longer-term measures such as dollar/rupee swaps, OMO sales of securities or CRR enhancement, any resultant upward pressure on interest rates could have wider economic consequences, including higher government borrowing costs. These effects may not be immediately visible, but could nevertheless have a negative impact on the economy.

Srinivasan Velamur
Chennai

Lingering mistrust

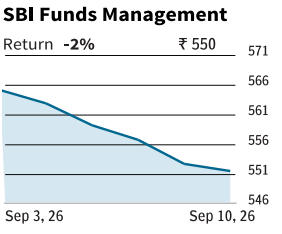
With reference to ‘25 years after 9/11: The shadow of mistrust’

(September 10), the legacy of 9/11 extends beyond terrorism; it reminds us how quickly fear can deepen suspicion between communities. Security agencies must remain alert, but counter-terrorism measures should not become collective suspicion based on religion, appearance or nationality. Schools and media must challenge stereotypes and verify information before it spreads. Communities can build trust through dialogue and local engagement. Remembering the victims should encourage societies to oppose violence without normalising prejudice.

SP Suganya Devi
Coimbatore

QUICKLY.

SBI MF launches 'Aarambh' for first-time investors



Mumbai: SBI Mutual Fund has launched Aarambh, an assisted digital onboarding service designed to make it easier for first-time investors to begin their MF journey with confidence. Aarambh, meaning 'a beginning,' has been built on a foundational insight: many new investors need guidance and a simple, seamless onboarding experience to become investment-ready. It enables an SBI branch official or authorised representative, SBI MF relationship manager or a MF distribution partner to support a prospective investor throughout the onboarding process, from their first conversation to completing their first investment in a single digital session. Our Bureau

Knack Global files IPO papers with SEBI

New Delhi: Carlyle-backed Knack Global Ltd, which operates under the brand name Knack RCM, has filed preliminary papers with SEBI for an IPO through the confidential route. Under this route, companies are allowed to keep their draft offer documents out of the public domain until the regulatory review process reaches a more advanced stage. As a result, details regarding the offer structure, financials, valuation and listing timeline are not available at this stage. Knack RCM provides revenue cycle management and credentialing services to healthcare providers, with a focus on converting patient encounters into compliant reimbursement. ㉞

NSE public issue: SBI, MS Strategic, BoB, others may cut stake sale size

DOWNSIZING. At the indicative price band of ₹1,700-1,785, the IPO would be worth around ₹21,500-22,600 cr

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Several major shareholders of the National Stock Exchange have sharply reduced the number of shares they plan to sell in the exchange's initial public offering (IPO), bringing the offer size down to around 12.4 crore shares from 14.89 crore proposed earlier, according to people aware of the development. The revised offer would represent around 5.1-5.2 per cent of NSE's equity, compared with 6 per cent earlier.

SBI TO GO SLOW State Bank of India (SBI), the largest selling shareholder, has cut its proposed sale to 1.597 crore shares from 2.475 crore. SBI Capital Markets will sell 87.8 lakh shares,

but this represents a transfer of part of the SBI group's earlier allocation and does not increase the overall offer. MS Strategic (Mauritius) has reduced its offer to 1.10 crore shares from 1.60 crore, while Bank of Baroda will sell 76.9 lakh shares against 1.099 crore earlier. Stock Holding Corporation of India has cut its proposed sale to 61.9 lakh shares from 1.089 crore, while General Insurance Corporation of India will offer 61.9 lakh shares against 1.066 crore earlier. National Insurance Company will sell 40 lakh shares against 60 lakh earlier, Mahag Investments 30 lakh against 50 lakh, and Indian Bank 15 lakh against 24.8 lakh. Amit Kumar Lohia, who had proposed to sell up to 25,000 shares at the DRHP



STANDING FIRM. Canada Pension Plan Investment Board, Aranda Investments, New India Assurance, United India Insurance, Crown Capital, Ontario Inc may stick to original stake sale plan

stage, does not appear in the RHP. **VALUATION CONCERNS** The reductions come as shareholders reassess the valuation they could receive through the IPO at the

lower-than-earlier expected price band. NSE shares have been trading above ₹2,000 in the unlisted market. At the indicative price band of ₹1,700-1,785 a share, the IPO would be worth around ₹21,500-22,600

Sensex, Nifty snap 3-session losing streak on CAS recovery

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Equity benchmarks snapped a three-session losing streak on Thursday, with a sharp recovery in the closing auction session (CAS), helping the Sensex and Nifty finish in positive territory despite Brent crude prices climbing to around \$102 a barrel. The BSE Sensex gained 138.36 points to settle at 74,902.59, while the Nifty 50 rose 46.30 points to 23,477.80. Benchmarks remained volatile through the session, but late buying helped the index recover. Bank Nifty also saw a sharp spike during the closing auc-

tion session. The recovery came against a cautious backdrop, with elevated crude oil prices, geopolitical tensions and inflation concerns. Abhinav Tiwari, Research Analyst at Bonanza, said the late recovery appeared to be driven more by relief buying than a clear change in the market trend. **BROADER WEAKNESS** Despite the headline indices ending higher, the Nifty Mid-cap 100 and Nifty Smallcap 100 closed in negative territory. Within the Nifty 500 universe, 308 stocks ended lower, highlighting the broad-based weakness.

Adani Ports executives settle SEBI proceedings in PMC projects case

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Karan Adani, MD, APSEZ

Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) Managing Director Karan Adani and former chief financial officer B Ravi have settled adjudication proceedings involving PMC projects with the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI). Both have paid ₹13.65 lakh each on September 5, following which the proceedings were disposed of. The regulator had issued show-cause notices to the two executives on November 22, 2023. The regulator's investiga-

tion covered compliance with provisions of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act, 1956, the Sebi Act and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, in relation to the transactions between PMC Pro-

jects and APSEZ and its subsidiaries. **SEBI PROBE** The proceedings relate to SEBI's investigation into banking transactions and inter-corporate security deposits between PMC projects, APSEZL and its subsidiaries. The regulator had alleged that the two executives violated provisions of the SEBI LODR regulations, along with Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act. The recommendation of the High Powered Advisory Committee on settlement terms was approved by a panel of SEBI's whole-time members on August 13.

SIP inflows at record ₹32,297 cr in August

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Inflows into mutual funds through systematic investment plans (SIPs) hit a fresh record high of ₹32,297 crore in August, up from ₹31,861 crore in July, even as equity markets remained turbulent due to geopolitical tensions and higher crude oil prices. Interestingly, investments in small-cap funds remained buoyant at ₹7,973 crore, compared with ₹7,767 crore in July, according to data released by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) on Thursday. Mid-cap funds recorded even higher inflows of ₹6,989 crore, up from ₹6,192 crore in the previous month.

SIP ACCOUNTS The number of contributing SIP accounts also reached an all-time high of 10.2 crore, compared with 9.9 crore in July. Venkat Chalasani, CEO of AMFI, said that despite geopolitical concerns and rising crude prices, investors continued to believe in India's growth story.

He added that the RBI's ability to absorb \$127 billion has been a significant achievement considering past experiences. Inflows into equity funds rose 19 per cent to ₹29,329 crore in August from ₹24,697 crore in July. Outflows from large-cap funds eased marginally to ₹1,147 crore from ₹1,322 crore. The newly introduced life-cycle funds attracted inflows of ₹8 crore. The industry's overall AUM increased to ₹87.07 lakh crore from ₹85.76 lakh crore, largely driven by mark-to-market gains. Manish Mehta, Chief Business Officer at SBI Mutual Fund, said while new fund offer (NFO) mobilisations of ₹3,051 crore in equity schemes and ₹1,848 crore in

Surging ahead

	2026	2025
August	32,297	28,265
July	31,961	28,464
June	31,781	27,269
May	30,954	26,688
April	31,115	26,632

other categories contributed to net sales, mid-cap and small-cap schemes continued to account for a significant share of inflows. Harish Krishnan, CIO - Equity at Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC, said the growing strength of equity inflows reflects sustained participation in the broader market and confidence in India's long-term growth prospects. At the same time, he cautioned that the small-cap segment requires careful differentiation, given the wide dispersion in valuations and underlying fundamentals. Saugata Chatterjee, President and Deputy CEO of Nippon India Mutual Fund, said record-high SIP contributions and a moderating stoppage ratio underscore the growing investment discipline among Indian investors.

GOLD ETFs He said that strong investor interest in Gold ETFs, which received inflows of ₹2,597 crore compared with ₹1,559 crore in July, along with consistent investments in multi-asset allocation funds, reflects a growing preference for diversification and balanced portfolio allocation amid global uncertainty. Gaurav Goyal, Chief Business Officer at Canara Robeco AMC, said the opportunity for the MF industry now lies in converting this growing participation into deeper engagement by helping investors remain focused on their financial goals and investment horizons.

ARCIL: Keep the interest aside for now

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd or ARCIL's OFS-only IPO worth ₹733 crore closes today. The company manages securitisation trusts (trusts) or special purpose vehicles (SPVs) that buy bad loans from banks and make money in the event of recovering dues that exceed the initial acquisition price of the loans. ARCIL's promoters Avenue India Resurgence and SBI, along with a few public shareholders pare stake in the OFS.

IPO ANALYSIS.

Asset reconstruction is a good business to be in, if one can crack it. As long as there is credit growth, growth in stressed assets cannot be ruled out. As of FY26, stressed assets of banks and NBFCs across retail, corporate and SME segments amount to ₹23.7 lakh crore. While some of them may have been sold to asset reconstruction companies (ARCs), the rest are being managed by the lenders themselves. ARCIL's AUM, on comparison, is a tiny ₹20,150 crore. However, that sounds good only on paper as the business is too complex to execute. One bad purchase decision can erode substantial capital. IRR targets set at the time of acquisition of stressed assets may not be met. Collections or recoveries often come in lumps. Legal proceedings can take longer for resolution. ARCIL's FY24-26 paint the picture of a healthy, profitable business. AUM has expanded from ₹15,230 crore to ₹20,150 crore, revenue from ₹570 crore to ₹753 crore and profit from ₹305 crore to ₹408 crore. These are standalone figures and best represent the ARC's business. ARCIL's consolidated financials that consolidate the SPVs it manages, need to be looked only as regulatory compliance.

How the numbers stack up

Standalone figures

	FY24	FY25	FY26
Total AUM (₹ crore)	15,230	16,853	20,150
ARCIL's share in AUM (%)	18.1	19.6	21.9
Acquisitions in the year (₹ crore)	2,069	3,976	5,959
SR redemption for the year (₹ crore)	2,953	2,223	2,638
Cumulative SR redemption ratio (%)*	51.3	51.8	50.8
Revenue (₹ crore)	570	596	753
Net profit (₹ crore)	305	355	408
RoA (%)	11.5	11.7	10.6
RoE (%)	13.0	13.6	14.0
Debt-to-equity (x)	0.1	0.1	0.4

*Cumulative SRs redeemed by the trusts divided by cumulative SRs issued by the trusts till the end of that year

SR: security receipts

Source: RHP

The issue values ARCIL at ₹4,516 crore or about 1.5x book value. It may seem inexpensive considering the business generates RoA of about 11 per cent. However, in the ARC business, three years may not be adequate to draw concrete conclusions about future profitability. Going forward, growth is dependent on fresh acquisitions and timely collections, which are difficult to estimate reasonably, in the absence of management's guidance. The RHP also does not identify any listed peer to build a perspective on valuation. Given this situation, we advise investors to give the IPO a pass for now and probably revisit the company once post-listing disclosures begin.

ABOUT ARCIL

Incorporated in 2002, ARCIL is India's first ARC and has experience dealing with all credit cycles since. It is currently the second largest ARC after NARCL. NARCL may not be ARCIL's rival as it was floated primarily to deal with large, legacy stressed assets of over ₹500 crore. ARCIL manages an AUM of ₹20,150 crore, of which, 69 per cent is corporate loans, 23 per cent is retail loans and about 8 per cent is SME and other loans. Per RBI Directions, ARCs are required to invest their own funds in the trusts they manage, alongside other investors (qualified buyers or QBs) when acquiring stressed

assets. This along with 'cash acquisitions' (discussed in deal structures) amounts to about 22 per cent of the AUM. ARCIL has a network of 988 lawyers, 206 collection agents and 218 registered valuers. Its CRAR is 65.3 per cent against a regulatory floor of 15 per cent. **BRASS TACKS** In general, banks and NBFCs auction stressed assets and invite bids. ARCs and other interested investors conduct due diligence of the portfolio and make an assessment of the purchase price at which their internal IRR target can be reached. This forms the basis for the bids. Bids above this price will only deliver a lower IRR. Once identifying a potential deal, ARCIL floats a trust (SPV). The trust issues security receipts (SRs) to raise funds. ARCIL and other QBs (like alternate asset managers, even selling banks themselves at times) subscribe to the SRs. On transferring funds to the selling bank or NBFC, the bad loans are then sold to the SPV. ARCIL creates a trust for each successful auction. Currently, it manages 487 live trusts. The acquisition price of the loans equates to the value of SRs issued by the SPVs and this forms ARCIL's AUM. Cumulatively, ARCIL has acquired ₹89,909 crore worth of loans for ₹44,114 crore or at about 49 per cent on average. Once the loans are

on the SPV's balance sheet, ARCIL, as its trustee, begins work on collections/ recoveries from the borrower. Recoveries largely take the form of restructuring (relaxing repayment terms), settlement (settling a ₹100 loan at ₹70 for example), enforcement of security interest (selling off collateral; 88 per cent of the AUM is secured) or legal proceedings in extreme cases.

DEAL STRUCTURES

ARCIL's acquisitions take the form of one of the following deal structures. In the first two structures, the selling bank or NBFC do not become QBs investing in the SPV, but they do in the other two. 1. Cash acquisitions - Where ARCIL is the sole QB and uses its own funds to fund the SPV. 2. Co-investor acquisitions - Where ARCIL invests in the SRs with other QBs. ARCIL is regulatorily required to invest at least 2.5 per cent of SRs here. 3. Ordinary SR acquisitions - Where ARCIL invests in the SRs alongside the selling bank or NBFC. Here, the regulatory minimum investment for ARCIL is the higher of 15 per cent of SRs subscribed by the seller (bank) or 2.5 per cent of total SRs issued. 4. Structured acquisitions - This works similar to ordinary SR deals. But the difference is that ARCIL's returns are capped in favour of preferential treatment. It makes money more by way of management fee than investment income in such deals (covered in revenue model). As of FY26, of AUM outstanding for less than eight years, the four deal structures account for 11, 0.2, 3.1 and 85.7 per cent respectively. AUM outstanding for less than eight years is 65 per cent of the total AUM. The significance of eight years is that, per RBI norms, SR holders must write-off the investment if the SRs are not fully redeemed

within eight years.

REVENUE MODEL

When collections begin, ARCIL takes the first cut as the manager and this forms the 'management, recovery fees' - the first revenue stream. This is generally agreed as a percentage of AUM (between 1 and 1.5 per cent of AUM in FY24-26) and accounted for 37.2 per cent of FY26 revenue. The recovered money after paying the manager's cut then accrues to the SR investors (including ARCIL). This is termed as SR redemptions. SR redemptions proportionate to ARCIL's stake along with 'upside' (when redemptions exceed the face value of SRs invested) if any, accrues to ARCIL as 'other operating income' - the second revenue stream. This accounted for 25.4 per cent of FY26 revenue.

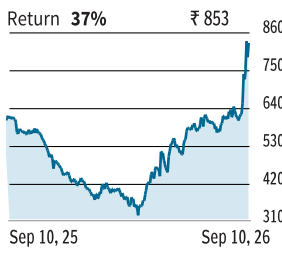
By regulation, the investments in SRs are required to be marked to market based on credit rating agencies' assessment of an NAV of the SRs. This results in an unrealised gain or loss and makes the third revenue stream. This accounted for 25.9 per cent of FY26 revenue. Investment in SRs outstanding for over eight years are written off. However, recovery proceedings can continue. Successful collections are written back as income and forms the fourth revenue stream. This accounted for 8.8 per cent of FY26 revenue. Interest income from investments other than in SRs form the fifth revenue stream, accounting for 2.7 per cent of FY26 revenue. The revenue streams' share in FY26 revenue is given just for perspective and their relative shares can vary in a different year. Except for management fees and interest income, external factors play a major role in deciding how much ARCIL can earn from the other revenue streams - and this makes it extremely difficult to model for.

TODAY'S PICK.

Raymond (₹853.50): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Raymond



The stock of Raymond, after gaining about 18 per cent last week, has shot up by a little over 15 per cent so far this week. Consequently, it has broken out of the important barrier at ₹750, opening the door for further upside. That said, from the current level, the stock might moderate to ₹750 from the current level. Notably, ₹750 will henceforth act as a support. But eventually, we expect it to resume the uptrend and rally to ₹1,000. So, traders can go long now at ₹853 and buy more shares if the scrip falls to ₹750.

Place initial stop-loss at ₹690. When the stock rises to ₹925, revise the stop-loss to ₹880. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹925 when the price hits ₹975. Book profits at ₹1,000. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23500 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
23300	23000	23680	23750	Sell if the contract rises to 23560; keep a stop-loss at 23700.	
₹694 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
680	670	700	715	The stock is likely to decline; go short with a stop-loss at 715.	
₹1031 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1025	1000	1050	1075	Short the stock if it moves up to 1050; stop-loss can be 1080.	
₹259 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
255	250	262	265	The trend is bearish; go short at 262 with a stop-loss at 266.	
₹237 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
235	230	238	242	Buy if the stock breaks out of 238; place a stop-loss at 232.	
₹1275 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1260	1250	1278	1290	The stock may decline; go short now with stop-loss at 1290.	
₹1004 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1000	985	1012	1020	Likely to depreciate; sell the stock now with stop-loss at 1015.	
₹2216 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2190	2150	2230	2275	Short the stock if it moves up to 2220; stop-loss can be 2250.	
S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.					

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 46.30 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	693.80	22.42	12.95	9.89	
Bharti Airtel	1839.00	16.15	30.77	5.20	
State Bank	1009.70	8.31	10.39	3.88	
L&T	3955.00	8.29	27.73	4.31	
PowerGrid Corp	271.75	5.84	15.90	1.15	
Axis Bank	1246.00	4.71	13.87	3.33	
Kotak Bank	416.55	4.10	20.41	2.85	
HDFC Life	526.15	2.86	57.48	0.53	
ONGC	237.27	2.76	6.66	0.86	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1038.00	2.37	21.58	1.35	
Tech Mahindra	1525.80	2.47	28.96	0.90	
Bajaj Finance	1043.50	2.46	31.46	2.60	
Eternal Ltd.	322.10	2.37	717.87	2.17	
UltraTech Cement	10979.00	2.04	37.75	1.21	
Bajaj Finserv	1940.50	1.71	15.05	1.05	
SBI Life	1700.60	1.63	65.59	0.71	
Grossm Ind	3319.00	1.57	19.85	1.17	
Titan	5021.00	1.44	77.39	1.93	
Cipla	1373.30	1.25	33.06	0.73	
Infosys	1036.50	1.15	13.87	0.38	
Asian Paints	2498.10	0.90	49.54	1.05	
Coal India	432.00	0.52	8.54	0.96	
WIPAC	335.00	0.52	11.46	1.46	
Max Healthcare	1038.60	0.18	69.36	0.72	
Trent Ltd.	2818.70	-0.09	82.83	0.87	
DataConsumerProduct	999.60	-0.20	60.24	0.61	
Dr Reddys Lab	1143.00	-0.27	29.97	0.65	
Wipro	166.30	-0.41	12.40	0.42	
Hind Unilever	1942.30	-0.52	43.49	1.80	
Bajaj Auto	11768.40	-0.53	28.47	1.29	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	320.25	-0.54	73.57	0.70	
Bharat Elec	405.00	-0.78	48.16	1.35	
Maruti Suzuki	12590.00	-0.80	27.61	1.53	
TCS	2014.00	-0.87	15.93	2.09	
Sun Pharma	1861.00	-0.90	36.85	1.83	
NestleIndia	1185.40	-1.01	70.14	0.93	
Adani Ports	1768.00	-1.13	31.05	1.21	
Eicher Motors	7697.00	-1.13	36.60	0.99	
Tata Motors PV	300.50	-1.14	0.00	0.58	
JSW Steel	1304.00	-1.23	11.39	1.14	
IntGlobeAvi	4945.00	-1.48	0.00	1.04	
Apollo Hosp	8903.00	-1.51	58.52	0.85	
Adani Enter	3077.20	-1.73	53.29	1.68	
ITC	259.30	-3.16	16.10	2.33	
Tata Steel	186.78	-3.56	20.70	1.44	
Hindalco	1014.00	-4.08	13.89	1.37	
M&M	3123.80	-5.11	19.19	2.60	
HCL Tech	1207.00	-5.25	18.79	1.18	
CICI Bank	1384.50	-7.50	16.62	2.02	
Reliance Ind	1274.00	-7.38	19.55	8.01	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▼ 322.95 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
CholamandalamKin	1859.00	37.72	27.56	3.22	
Bank of Baroda	237.62	18.98	6.68	1.77	
Varun Beverages	410.50	13.91	40.73	2.25	
Punjab Natl Bank	116.85	12.41	6.07	1.61	
Hyundai Motor India	2205.00	9.36	36.19	1.26	
Muthootfin	2841.50	8.26	9.96	1.22	
Godrej Consumer	869.90	7.12	46.52	1.40	
Power Finance	352.80	5.92	3.46	2.06	
Canak Bank	124.60	5.08	5.70	1.68	
DIF	65.85	1.40	36.52	1.69	
Siemens	395.40	1.36	28.43	1.18	
Solar Industries	2237.00	1.06	98.73	2.18	
Tata Capital	363.15	1.02	28.14	0.73	
Torrent Pharma	4930.00	1.08	76.98	2.90	
Siemens Energy India	3179.10	-1.18	86.08	11.93	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	81.08	-1.81	14.74	0.65	
Macrotech Developers	1163.40	-2.10	28.15	1.29	
Amul Cement	102.50	-2.54	18.95	0.99	
Purit India	313.80	-2.54	5.15	0.57	
Rudolph	1569.20	-2.70	59.67	1.95	
Gail (India)	174.49	-3.21	11.62	1.89	
Bpcl	303.00	-3.24	7.67	2.46	
Hdfc AMC	2433.80	-3.67	35.39	1.99	
United Spirits	1400.00	-4.46	60.36	1.66	
Mazagon Dock	2383.20	-5.65	33.69	0.73	
Central India	608.00	-6.08	22.22	2.22	
Sree Cement	2278.00	-6.41	50.25	1.22	
Savarmadhotsonintermatl	163.20	-6.42	37.81	2.89	
Zyduslifecycle	1117.80	-6.98	24.49	1.12	
Indian Oilcorp	134.94	-7.17	5.33	2.02	
Bosch	4877.50	-8.19	60.87	1.70	
Indian Steel	117.10	-10.23	42.82	1.69	
Ltintimetre	4374.00	-10.26	24.97	1.63	
Bajaj Auto	10992.00	-10.82	42.82	1.63	
Abb India	7329.00	-11.06	99.86	1.54	
Tata Power	367.00	-14.54	22.31	2.45	
AdaniGreenergy	1299.10	-15.49	99.71	1.75	
Hindus Zinc	593.60	-16.49	14.70	1.14	
Adani Power	213.50	-16.68	28.33	3.55	
Vedanta	26.905	-17.00	6.30	1.83	
Adani Logistics Co	71.575	-17.86	44.13	2.52	
Divis Lab	94.880	-18.28	55.66	3.88	
Tvs Motor Corp	421.50	-20.21	54.37	3.88	
AvenueSuper	3690.00	-21.07	78.72	2.38	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	914.55	-24.71	116.34	2.51	
Union Bank	127.90	-26.34	6.63	1.39	
Britannia Ind	509.00	-27.73	46.22	2.36	
HindustanAeronaotics	4950.00	-27.84	35.51	3.76	
AdaniEnergy Solutions	139.50	-28.97	51.93	1.83	
Tata Motors cv	439.25	-34.60	38.63	3.68	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

Mobile chain SS Retail to raise ₹500 crore via IPO



Mumbai: SS Retail, a multi-brand retail chain for mobile phones and other electronic items, plans to raise ₹500 crore through a combination of fresh equity issuance and offer-for-sale on the mainboard. The company has fixed the price band at ₹403-424 per equity share. The issue opens for bidding on Wednesday. **OUR BUREAU**

Jindal Supreme eyes ₹125 crore via IPO

Mumbai: Jindal Supreme (India), an integrated steel manufacturer of pipes, tubes and allied infrastructure products for over five decades, plans to raise ₹125 crore through an initial public offering (IPO) on the mainboard. The company will issue 1.34 crore equity shares in the price band of ₹88-93 a share. The issue will open for subscription on Wednesday. **OUR BUREAU**

Veefin Solutions to migrate to mainboard

Mumbai: Veefin Solutions has initiated the process for migration of its equity shares from the SME platform to the mainboard of BSE and direct listing on the NSE. The firm has submitted its information memorandum to BSE on Tuesday for migration and will file an application for direct listing on NSE after approval from BSE. Raja Debnath, its CMD, said the company has significantly expanded its product portfolio, customer ecosystem and international presence since listing on the SME platform. **OUR BUREAU**

Greenwave raises \$31 m to build recycling capacity

Bengaluru: Indian recycling and sustainable packaging company Greenwave Circularity has raised \$31.5 million from OeEB, the Development Bank of Austria, with the financing backed by the European Union's European Fund for Sustainable Development Plus (EFSD+) under its Transforming Global Value Chains programme. It will be used to build out Greenwave's greenfield plastic recycling capacity in India. **OUR BUREAU**

‘Organised apparel retail sector may clock 13% growth this fiscal’

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

With consumers increasingly diversifying discretionary spending, India's organised apparel retail sector's revenue growth is expected to be at 12-13 per cent this fiscal, slightly lower than 15 per cent recorded last fiscal.

Strong traction in value fashion, the expansion of organised retail beyond large cities and sustained demand for branded apparel should support growth, a report by Crisil Ratings said.

However, operating margins are likely to compress by about 100 basis points to about 14 per cent due to rising cotton prices and elevated operating costs, which will be passed on to consumers only partially.

“The festive season, which has recently commenced, will be crucial to the sector's growth outlook because festive spending typically accounts for nearly 35 per cent of annual apparel sales. Revenue growth has been broadly steady so far, in the high single digits between April and August 2026, but has largely been driven by the value-fashion segment,” it added.

Anuj Sethi, Senior Director, Crisil Ratings, said, “Value fashion has emerged as the key growth driver for organised retailers, growing

Hero Motors plans ₹1,000 cr IPO, focuses on electric mobility push

GROWTH ENGINE. The company prices issue at ₹79-84 a share, targeting a valuation of about ₹3,815 crore

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Hero Motors Ltd is seeking a valuation of about ₹3,815 crore in its ₹1,000 crore initial public offering (IPO), pricing the September 16-18 issue at ₹79-84 a share as the Pankaj Munjal-led automotive-components maker raises capital to cut debt and expand powertrain capacity.

Of the offer, ₹600 crore is a fresh issue, while ₹400 crore, or 40 per cent, will go to selling shareholders, including ₹395 crore to promoter O P Munjal Holdings and ₹5 crore to Hero Cycles.

The IPO comes as Hero Motors increasingly pivots towards electric powertrains and bets on a recovery in Europe's e-bike market. E-mobility revenue jumped 55.6 per cent to ₹273.29 crore in FY26, raising its share of revenue to 23 per



NEW LEVER. (from left) Amit Gupta, Hero Motors MD & CEO, Pankaj M Munjal, Chairman, Abhishek Munjal, Director, Utkarsh Sanghi, CFO and Keshav Misra, Director, at the IPO roadshow

cent from 16.1 per cent.

The growth, however, comes against a 46.2 per cent fall in US revenue and low utilisation at some newer facilities, leaving investors to weigh a fast-growing EV portfolio against the challenge of converting capacity built ahead of demand into returns.

“We are not just the manufacturing partner; we are a technology partner,” Chairman Pankaj Munjal said, as Hero Motors moves up the value chain from supplying components to designing,

developing and integrating powertrain systems.

The company will use ₹190 crore of the fresh proceeds to repay or prepay borrowings and ₹200 crore to buy equipment for expanding capacity at its Gautam Buddha Nagar facility in Uttar Pradesh.

The underlying machinery programme is estimated at about ₹228 crore and includes 26 machines.

POWERTRAIN REVENUE Powertrain solutions have meanwhile overtaken the

company's legacy alloys and metallics operations. Powertrain revenue rose 19.4 per cent to ₹637.75 crore in FY26, accounting for 53.7 per cent of revenue.

EVs now contribute 23 per cent of Hero Motors' revenue, while management said roughly 80 per cent of its R&D spending is directed towards EV and hybrid technologies.

The company spends about 7 per cent of revenue on R&D, including design, testing and validation of powertrain systems.

Europe provides another growth lever. European revenue jumped 28.8 per cent to ₹399.22 crore in FY26, helping offset the sharp US decline. Management said the region's e-bike industry, hit by a severe post-Covid inventory correction, began clearing excess stocks last year and has returned to growth.

“Powertrain solutions have grown much more, and we have added more customers,” Managing Director and CEO Amit Gupta said. “Our overall strategy is to diversify going forward.”

Hero Motors enters the IPO with FY26 revenue up 9.1 per cent to ₹1,188.35 crore and net profit up 25.5 per cent to ₹41.17 crore. EVs are already nearly a quarter of its business; the harder part now is filling the capacity built for that transition and making those investments deliver returns.

Kanohar Electricals, Glass Wall IPOs get strong bids; Prasol sails through

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Of the three mainboard IPOs — Kanohar Electricals, Glass Wall Systems (India) and Prasol Chemicals — the former two witnessed aggressive demand even as the latter saw modest demand across investor categories on the closing day. Kanohar Electricals was subscribed 90.59 times, Glass Wall Systems (India) was booked 81.65 times, while Prasol Chemicals received 3.30 times subscription.

SUBSCRIPTION STATUS Kanohar Electricals IPO was subscribed 215.37 times by qualified institutional buyers (QIBs), 87.74 times by non-institutional investors (NIIs) and 20.51 times by retail investors.

Glass Wall Systems (India) IPO was booked 81.65 times.

QIBs subscribed 167.93 times the portion reserved for them, while the NII and retail portions were subscribed 79.71 times and 33.18 times respectively.

Healthy demand

	QIBs	Non-institutions	Retail	No. of times Total
Kanohar Electricals	215.37	87.74	20.51	90.59
Glass Wall Systems	167.93	79.71	33.18	81.65
Prasol Chemicals	7.22	1.80	1.70	3.30

Source: Exchange

Prasol Chemicals IPO was subscribed 3.30 times overall. The QIB portion was subscribed 7.22 times, while the NII and retail portions were booked 1.80 times and 1.70 times respectively.

KANOHAR ELECTRICALS The ₹1,056-crore IPO comprises a fresh issue of shares worth up to ₹300 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 1.2 crore shares, valued at ₹756 crore at the higher end of the price band, by promoter K Sons Family Trust.

The price band has been fixed at ₹601-632 per equity share. The company plans to use ₹64.1 crore from the fresh issue towards capital expenditure requirements, including purchasing machinery and equipment for its Gangol manufacturing facility, expanding and automating backward integration facilities, civil construction

and interior development of an office building, and sustainability initiatives.

Another ₹155 crore will be used to fund incremental working capital requirements, with the remaining proceeds earmarked for general corporate purposes.

Kanohar Electricals has raised ₹317 crore from anchor investors.

GLASS WALL IPO Glass Wall Systems (India)'s ₹428-crore IPO has a price band of ₹172-182 per equity share.

The mainboard issue comprises a fresh issuance of equity shares worth up to ₹60 crore and an offer-for-sale of 2.02 crore equity shares by promoters Jawahar Hariaram Hemrajani and Eshan Jawahar Hemrajani, and investor shareholder India Business Excellence Fund IIA.

Milky Mist sets up Greek yoghurt, Skyr plant in TN

Our Bureau
Chennai

Value-added dairy company Milky Mist has announced the commissioning of its new Skyr and Greek yoghurt manufacturing plant in Tamil Nadu.

The unit is located within the company's integrated manufacturing facility in Perundurai, Erode. Built with an investment of approximately ₹40 crore, the new exclusive plant has a processing capacity of up to 150 tonnes per day.

PROTEIN DEMAND

Milky Mist said it was the first company in India back in 2022 to introduce ultra-filtration technology for manufacturing Skyr and Greek yoghurt with growing consumer preference for high-protein nutrition.

“The commissioning of our advanced manufacturing for Skyr and Greek yoghurt represents a strategic expansion of our technological capabilities. With processing capacity of up to 150 tonnes per day, it provides us with the scale to serve rising demand, accelerate innovation and expand the category. This investment strengthens Milky Mist's position in the high-protein segment,” said K K Rathnam, Wholetime Director and Chief Executive Officer, Milky Mist Dairy Food.

Bahrain court rules in favour of HDFC Bank in CS AT1 case

Our Bureau
Mumbai

HDFC Bank on Thursday said it has received favourable orders from the High Civil Court, Bahrain, on September 9, 2026, in two proceedings initiated against it by the investors of Credit Suisse Additional Tier 1 bonds (CS AT1).

“Between July and August 2026, the Bahrain court also rejected five other similar matters concerning investors of CS AT1... In all the seven judgments by the court, the investors were ordered to bear the costs of the proceedings,” the bank said.

The latest orders follow

judicial scrutiny of these investors claims and the evidentiary materials placed before the Bahrain court.

INVESTOR CLAIMS

The bank, in a statement, said the seven investors in their complaints had all alleged gross negligence, intentional misrepresentation, incorrect customer classification, non-disclosure of product features/characteristics, misuse of financial leverage and violation of product suitability principles with respect to their investment in CS AT1 bonds through the bank.

Further, the Bahrain court

rejected the investors' claims after finding that they had failed to produce sufficient admissible evidence to prove/substantiate these allegations against it.

The bank said the outcomes in the Bahrain court follow dismissal by the National Consumer Dispute Redressal Commission (NCDRC) in March 2026 of complaints by the investors.

“In its order, NCDRC affirmed that the bank was only a facilitator and the investors had full autonomy to make their investments in CS AT1 bonds as per their choice,” according to the statement.



MAITHON POWER LIMITED
(Contracts Department)
Maithon Power Ltd, Village: Dambhui, PO Barbindia, PIN-828205, District-Dhanbad

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Maithon Power Limited, a joint venture between Tata Power and DVC invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the following packages:

S.No.	Ref. No	Package Description
1	1000080918	Supply of FUEL, AGRO-BASED BIOMASS PELLETS at MPL

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit our website URL- <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>
Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **18-Sep-26**.



ISGEC HEAVY ENGINEERING LIMITED
CIN: L23423HR1933PLC000097
Registered Office: Radaur Road, Yamunanagar – 135001, Haryana
Telephone: +91-1732-661061 / 661158
Email: roynr@isgect.com, Website: www.isgect.com

NOTICE

i) NOTICE is hereby given that pursuant to provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act"), Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (as amended), Regulation 44 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard on General Meeting (SS-2) and the Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, the Company is pleased to provide its Members, facility for voting by electronic means to enable them to exercise their right to vote on resolutions proposed to be considered at the **93rd Annual General Meeting (AGM)** scheduled to be held on **Monday, September 28, 2026, at 11:00 a.m. (Indian Standard Time)** through Video Conferencing (VC) or Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) for which purpose the Registered Office of the Company situated at Radaur Road, Yamunanagar-135001, Haryana, shall be deemed as the venue for the AGM. The Company has engaged the services of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL), for facilitating voting through electronic means, as the authorized agency. The facility of casting votes by a Member using remote e-voting system as well as e-voting on the day of the AGM will be provided by NSDL.

ii) In compliance with the aforesaid MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars, the Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 has already been sent on **Thursday, September 03, 2026** through electronic mode to the Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company or the Depository Participant(s). Physical letters have already been sent to shareholders who have not registered their email addresses with the Company.

iii) The Notice of AGM along with the Annual Report 2025-26 is available on Company's website at www.isgect.com in the Investor Relations Section under Annual Report tab and also on NSDL website at www.evoting.nsdl.com and on BSE Limited website at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com.

iv) The remote e-voting shall commence from **Friday, September 25, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. (Indian Standard Time)** and will end on **Sunday, September 27, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time)**. The remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time.

v) The **cut-off date** for determining the eligibility to vote by electronic means is **Monday, September 21, 2026**. A person, whose name appears in Register of Members/Beneficial owners as on the cut – off date only, shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting or e-voting during the AGM.

vi) Any person, who acquires shares of the Company and become member of the Company after sending of the Notice through electronic means and holding shares as on the cut-off date, i.e., September 21, 2026, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in or Company/ RTA at roynr@isgect.com, ria@alankit.com and ramap@alankit.com. However, if the person is already registered with NSDL for remote e-voting then he/she can use the existing user ID and password for casting vote.

vii) The Members are being provided with a facility to attend the AGM through VC/OAVM through the NSDL e-voting system. The instructions for attending the AGM through VC/OAVM are provided in the Notice of the AGM.

viii) The Members attending the AGM who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be eligible to cast their vote through e-voting during the AGM. The Members who have voted through remote e-voting shall be eligible to attend the AGM, however, they shall not be eligible to vote at the meeting.

ix) The procedure for electronic voting is available in the Notice of the AGM as well in the e-mail sent to the Members by NSDL. The Members can also refer "e-voting user manual" available in the download section of the e-voting website of NSDL www.evoting.nsdl.com.

x) In case of any queries, you may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) for the Shareholders and e-voting user manual for the Shareholders available at the downloads section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on toll free No.: 022-4886 7000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mhate, Assistant Vice President, NSDL at evoting@nsdl.com.

For Isgect Heavy Engineering Limited
(Sachin Saluja)
Company Secretary
Membership No. A24269

QUICKLY.

Novartis’ Dube appointed as OPPI President

Mumbai: A platform that represents multinational drugmakers, the Organisation of Pharmaceutical Producers of India (OPPI) has appointed Amitabh Dube as President, for two years, with immediate effect. Dube is currently the Country President and Managing Director of Swiss drugmaker Novartis in India, and has nearly three decades of experience in the pharmaceutical industry. **OUR BUREAU**

Job cut, plant closure cost seen at €16b: Volkswagen

Berlin: Volkswagen estimates the total cost of job cuts and potential plant closures, part of a landmark restructuring pact struck last week, at around €16 billion (\$18.6 billion), a person familiar with the matter said on Thursday. The plan includes exploring alternatives for four German plants that will eventually run out of models during the next decade and a reduction of around 50,000 more positions than previously planned. **REUTERS**

EPF exempted establishments can invest in NDB rupee bonds

BROADER CHOICES. Move expands investment options for private provident fund trusts

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government on Thursday included specified bond of New Development Bank for investment by exempted entities under Employees Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO). According to a notification by the Labour Ministry, under the ‘Debt Instruments and Related Investments’ category, rupee bonds having an outstanding maturity of at least three years from New Development Bank (NDB) has been included along with those issued by International Bank for Reconstruction and Development, International Finance Corporation and Asian Development Bank. Under this, an exempted establishment can invest minimum of 35 per cent and maximum of 45 per cent. It may be noted that EPF Exempted Establishment means an employer entity that has set up a Private



LENDING EXPANSION. NDB has also become a growing player in multi currency lending using currency swaps **KAMAL NARANG**

Provident Fund Trust for coverage of its employees and has obtained exemption under Section 17 of the Employees’ Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act. These entities are permitted to manage their own PF Trust without making statutory contributions. Such exempted establishments are statutorily mandated to provide benefits that are at least on par with those provided by EPFO to subscribers and comply with the notified conditions of exemption as outlined in the

Act. In her speech during recently held BRICS Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors Meeting, NDB President Dilma Rousseff said that the institution’s planned Indian Rupee bond program aims to mobilise around ₹250 billion equivalent to \$2.5 billion over five years, deepening India’s domestic bond market while helping borrowers, including private sector ones, reduce currency risk. “We shall remember that the provision for India sovereign loan in the next five years is \$1 billion year,

totaling \$5 billion . So, NDB provision for the period is a total investment in India of \$7.5 billion,” she said. Besides that, NDB has also become a growing player in multi currency lending using currency swaps. Second, on financing: we are accelerating non-sovereign operations, engaging more deeply with private sector via direct lending, or through public-private partnerships and using blended finance. Under our current General Strategy, NDB has set a target of 30 percent of financing to non-sovereign operations. “For our next strategy cycle, covering 2027 to 2031, we aim for 35 percent, alongside an expanded local-currency target of 40 to 50 percent, a climate finance target of 45 percent, and a new target of 10 percent for innovation and digital transformation projects, from smart hospitals to intelligent transport and infrastructure systems,” she said.

SC remands Cairn’s ₹5.25-crore SEBI penalty case back to SAT

The Hindu Bureau
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has remanded to the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT) a dispute concerning a ₹5.25-crore penalty imposed by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) on Cairn India, now part of Vedanta Ltd, over an allegedly misleading advertisement for a proposed buy-back of shares in 2014. A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K.V. Viswanathan held that the

release of money kept in escrow for the proposed buy-back did not, by itself, prevent SEBI from separately examining whether the company had committed fraud under the SEBI (Prohibition of Fraudulent and Unfair Trade Practices) Regulations, 2003 (PFUTP Regulations). “The mere release of the escrow does not create an automatic statutory bar to proceedings under the PFUTP Regulations because the release of the escrow is not necessarily equivalent to

absence of fraud,” the Bench said. The top court, however, found that SAT had not examined an apparent discrepancy between SEBI’s investigation report and a letter issued by the National Stock Exchange (NSE), describing the omission as a “material infirmity” that went to the root of the adjudicating officer’s order. “Since this is a material infirmity going to the evidentiary root of the AO’s order, one which SAT itself never examined or adjudicated

upon, we are of the view that the matter ought to be remanded to SAT so as to enable it to render a considered finding on this specific aspect, upon a proper examination of the record,” the Bench said in its 41-page ruling. The Bench accordingly directed SAT to undertake a fresh scrutiny of the trading data produced by both sides, including the NSE records, and ascertain which version reliably reflected the transactions in question. It further said that SAT

could exercise its powers under Section 15U(2) of the SEBI Act to summon and examine company officials, merchant bankers and others connected with the transactions, as well as call for documents necessary to establish the circumstances in which buy orders were placed during the buyback period. The top court, however, clarified that its observations should not influence the tribunal’s findings and gave it six months to complete the exercise.

Thoothukudi shipyard project in TN enters detailed project planning stage

Our Bureau
Chennai

A senior delegation from South Korean major HD Korea Shipbuilding & Off-shore Engineering (HD KSOE), led by global business team head Sunjoon Hong, has been on a 10-day visit to Tamil Nadu from September 1-10. During the visit they carried out a detailed survey in Thoothukudi and held discussions with the State Industries Minister Keerthana and other top officials of the Directorate General of Shipping, the State Industries department said on Thursday. *businessline* reported on Wednesday about the South Korean major meeting the State officials to advance discussions on the company’s investment in the Thoothukudi shipping cluster following MoUs



MAKES PROGRESS. Officials of HD KSOE with State Industries Minister Keerthana (second from left) and Industries Secretary Vijayakumar S

signed earlier. The HD KSOE team assured that they are moving ahead with the project in Thoothukudi, and the Minister assured the company of the State government’s full support, the department said. **GOING FORWARD** Subsequently, on Thursday, the HD KSOE also team met senior officials of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways on the policy-level support required from

the government to take the project forward. This takes the project forward from the MoU stage in December last year into detailed technical and project planning. “The government order for the land transfer for the first phase of around 1,700 acres has been given to SIPCOT, which will be building the common infrastructure along with VOC Port Authority,” said the Industries Department.

Ultraviolette set to scale output at ₹779 cr EV factory in Hosur

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Electric vehicle maker Ultraviolette Automotive is getting ready to scale its production as it launches its new facility — Big Global Ambition (BIGGA) Factory — near Hosur in Tamil Nadu. Ultraviolette’s cumulative investment in this facility over the next four to five years is set to be around ₹779 crore.

MOU SIGNED WITH TN The company signed an MoU with the State government in the investment conclave last month. Phase I will have capacity for around 2.5 lakh vehicles, while Phase II, expected after 2029, will double this to 5 lakh units. The construction of Phase I will be completed by Q1 2027. Ultraviolette’s future product portfolio includes multiple motorcycle seg-



WHAT’S IN STORE. Ultraviolette Automotive’s vision for BIGGA incorporates sustainability and automation techniques

ments (Sports, Crossover, Cruiser, Street) and scooters, including the Tesseract electric scooter. **SCALING UP PRODUCTION** “In the next three to four years, we forecast that the product mix for Ultraviolette would be 50-50 between scooters and motorcycles. The immediate volume ramp-up is more skewed towards the Tesseract

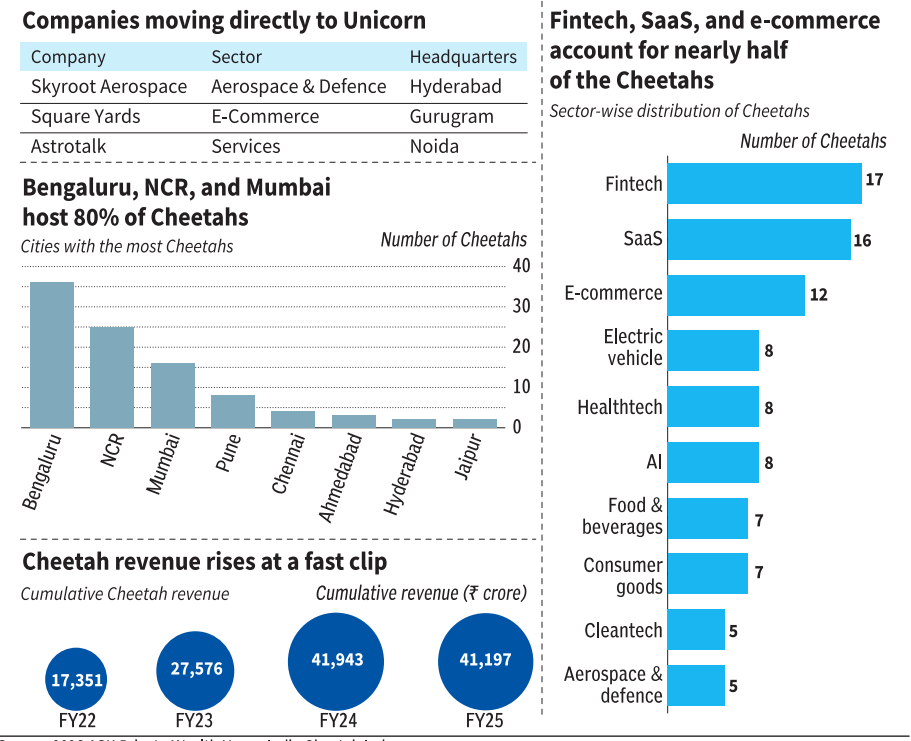
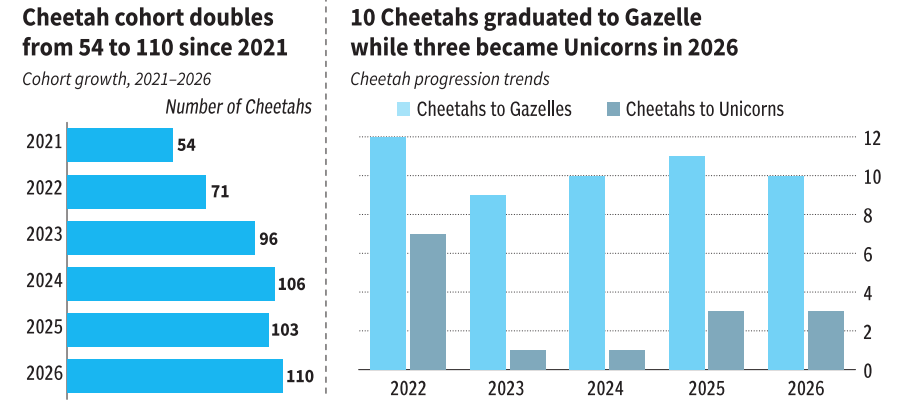
VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic: Visveswaran V

The cheetah index bounds forward

India’s pool of high-growth startups valued between \$200 million and \$500 million has more than doubled to 110 companies in 2026, from 54 in 2021. The 2026 ASK Private Wealth Hurun India Cheetah Index shows that the cohort has a combined valuation of over ₹3 lakh crore, while 43 new companies entered the list this year. Fintech, SaaS and e-commerce remain the largest sectors, even as electric mobility, cleantech, aerospace and defence and AI gain ground

Category	Definition	Valuation	Expected progression
Cheetah	Fast-growing, unlisted startup with high potential	\$200 million - \$500 million	Expected to become a Unicorn within 5 years
Gazelle	High-potential, unlisted startup	\$500 million - \$1 billion	Expected to become a Unicorn within 2-3 years
Unicorn	Private startup company with a valuation of \$1 billion or more	\$1 billion +	



‘Sixfold jump in Gestamp’s hot-stamped steel used in Indian cars’

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Gestamp India is betting on rising demand for safer, lighter vehicle structures as Bharat NCAP and five-star crash ratings push advanced structural technologies deeper into mass-market cars. The Spanish auto-components major expects its India business to grow through 2031, while adding giga-stamping capacity and investing ₹523.7 crore in Gujarat. Bharat NCAP and the growing focus on five-star crash-test ratings are reshaping how Indian cars are built. Pune-based Gestamp India said hot-stamped steel used in an average Indian-made passenger vehicle has risen sixfold to around 60 kg from roughly 10 kg six years ago, as stronger structural parts

spread from premium to entry-level cars. The sixfold increase reflects greater hot-stamped content per vehicle, rather than equivalent growth in Gestamp’s overall business. The Indian arm of the €11.3-billion Spanish auto-components major grew revenue to about 80 per cent over five years to roughly ₹2,200 crore in 2025, according to regulatory filings. Looking ahead, Gestamp expects India revenue to broadly track the passenger-vehicle market, which it sees growing 5–7 per cent annually through 2031, while investing ₹523.7 crore in its Bhagapura facility in Gujarat. Glyn Jones, Country Head & President of Gestamp India, spoke about India growth, crash safety and the technologies changing vehicle structures. *Edited excerpts:*

Our challenge is developing common architectures that can accommodate different requirements

GLYN JONES
Country Head & President of Gestamp India

Gestamp’s India revenue has grown around 80 per cent over five years. What do you see ahead?

India is a bright spot in the passenger vehicle market. We expect our sales revenue to grow broadly in line with the market, which we see growing around 5-7 per cent annually through 2031. We are well positioned for future growth and committed to further investment as required.



How much has hot stamping increased as crash safety becomes more important?

Ultra high-strength steel is becoming more prevalent in body-in-white structures. Today, hot stamping accounts for around 15 per cent of the average body-in-white structure. We are at around 60 kg of hot-stamped content per vehicle on average, a sixfold increase over six years. Safety is the most important factor in any body-in-white structure.

Has hot stamping moved beyond premium cars?

Previously, hot stamping was seen as a niche technology at a certain price level. Today, even entry-level B-segment cars have hot-stamped parts. We were a supplier partner on Tata Motors’ Altroz five-star NCAP programme and have since developed multiple solutions for customers in India.

What role are Bharat NCAP and India’s multiple powertrains playing?

Crash performance has become increasingly important with BNCAP. India also has diesel, petrol, CNG, BEVs, hybrids and range extenders. Our challenge is developing common architectures that can accommodate these different requirements. Our technical teams work with customers on CAE, BNCAP, CAFE and packaging.

What comes after hot stamping?

Giga stamping is the next evolution. Customers want more with less complexity. We can take the whole side of a vehicle and make it as one complete ring, whereas today it might require six or seven parts. It can also reduce the equipment customers require in their body shops and make the body-in-white more cost-effective.

How much capacity are you building for this growth?

We have two giga-stamping lines running in India — Pune and Bhagapura. A second Bhagapura line will be operational by the year-end. Pune and Chennai are running at around 80 per cent capacity, so we have room to grow. We have also acquired around 11 acres at Khed City near Pune for future expansion.

Navi Mumbai airport eyes more foreign routes with waiver in landing charges

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Navi Mumbai airport hopes to add international destinations with a one-year waiver in landing charges following a modification in its tariff order. In May, the Airport Economics Regulatory Authority (AERA) issued a tariff order for Navi Mumbai airport approving a variable fee structure. According to the order, concessions in landing fees would be applicable to a new route from Mumbai Metropolitan Region. The airport sector regulator has modified its order to enable concessional rates for new routes from Navi Mumbai airport. AERA issued the revision on Tuesday on Navi Mumbai airport’s request. The order comes

as Adani Group plans to shift one third of international flights from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai airport. According to the AERA order, airlines will receive full waiver on landing charges in the first year. The quantum of discounts will reduce for second and third year. At present, Navi Mumbai is only linked with Abu Dhabi by Air India Express, which operates three weekly services. In its submission to AERA last month, Navi Mumbai airport said airlines are unwilling to commence international flights, resulting in underutilisation of infrastructure. “The airlines have attributed this reluctance to the quantum of aeronautical tariffs notwithstanding the concession granted by the approved variable tariff plan,” said AERA.

QUICKLY.

ECB raises interest rates to tame inflation jump

Frankfurt: The European Central Bank raised interest rates for the second time this year in a widely flagged move on Thursday, hoping to tame an inflation rise driven entirely by higher energy costs from the Iran war. The ECB also lifted its 2026 economic growth projection to 0.9 per cent from 0.8 per cent seen in June and now sees inflation averaging 3 per cent this year and 2.5 per cent in 2027.Thursday's hike raises the ECB's benchmark deposit rate to 2.5 per cent.

REUTERS

Iran suspends freight charge on foreign vessels

Dubai: Iran has temporarily suspended a 10 per cent charge on freight fees for foreign vessels carrying imported or exported oil, gas and liquid petroleum products to and from Iran, the semi-official Fars news agency reported . The presidential legal deputy ordered the collection to stop until the government approves and publishes a list of products subject to the charge, Fars said.

REUTERS

SC asks Centre to review NEET-SS qualifying percentile

COURT VIEW. Expresses concern over large number of seats going unfilled annually

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court asked the Union government on Thursday to reconsider its decision to not reduce the cut-off percentile for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super Speciality seats (NEET-SS) in the current year while expressing concern about a large number of seats going unfilled annually.

The order from a Bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhie came after Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, for the Centre, said the government was willing to conduct a “stray round” for the vacant NEET-SS, but had decided to not lower the qualifying percentile.

She said the vacant seats would revert to States such as Tamil Nadu.

TN CASE

The court was hearing a petition filed by Tamil Nadu



NEXT HEARING. The court scheduled the case for further hearing and directions on September 17

Medical Officers Association, represented by senior advocate P Wilson, who said Tamil Nadu had 40 vacant seats left, and they should be returned to the State.

Wilson stressed that many eligible candidates, mostly in-service government doctors serving in rural parts of the State, were awaiting a reduction in the qualifying percentile. He said the NEET-SS seats were “precious”, and cannot remain vacant.

The court said the fact

that many seats remain unfilled make the case for reduction of qualifying percentile “rather compelling”.

Senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, for Tamil Nadu, said the State wanted the vacant seats to completely revert to it. It further urged for lowering the cut-off percentile. Justice Narasimha advised Bhati, on behalf of the Centre, to “reflect a little more” about bringing down the percentile, and even consult with

other members of the Bar on the issue.

Bhati urged the court then to “add a line” in its order “directing us to reconsider this... to consider reduction to the extent possible”. The law officer revealed that even some of the experts had “varying views” on the question of lowering the qualifying percentile.

“Some amount of reduction can be made. For last years, we had even reduced it [qualifying percentile] to zero per cent,” Bhati submitted. The court scheduled the case for further hearing and directions on September 17.

The petitioner-association had challenged the “premature diversion” of 152 vacant Super Speciality seats earmarked for in-service government doctors in Tamil Nadu to the All-India Quota. It had also sought protection of the State’s in-service reservation policy, pending a final decision on reduction of the NEET-SS qualifying percentile.

SC orders immediate action against those who threatened teen CJP protestor

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday asked Solicitor General of India Tushar Mehta to ensure “immediate action” by the Delhi Police on the FIR filed in Parliament Street Police Station by a 14-year-old student, who alleged open threats and harassment from vigilantes and miscreants for her role in the Cockroach Janta Party protests against NEET-UG question paper leaks.

“These are anti-social elements. They commit violence against a child, and they roam free. Now, they are again trying to browbeat and intimidate the child and her family, so that they do not proceed with any legal action. This is a very serious issue. Her cause is absolutely justified,” Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, observed.

The Bench, out of respect for the teenager’s privacy and safety, did not name her, and even asked her lawyer to not mention it in open court when live-streaming was on. The young student’s coun-



sel submitted that a “vigilante” had “bragged” on social media about the harm caused to the child and her family. “She is a bona fide victim. She is also a vulnerable victim. No irreversible harm should befall the child or her family,” the lawyer said.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, who accompanied the CJI on the Bench with Justice V Mohana, said the Uttar Pradesh Police should be made responsible for the safety of the student and her family, who reside within the State’s jurisdiction.

Counsel argued that vulnerable victims like her client should be able to safeguard their privacy by directly approaching the apex court or accessing the SC-appointed High-Powered Enquiry Committee, which was set up to in-

vestigate police and anti-social excesses against protesting students on July 20.

“The Committee is our extended hand. Whatever the committee does and finds, it will be placed before us only. Protection of vulnerable witnesses should not be less than that given in judicial proceedings... There should not be any obstacle to access for vulnerable victims,” Chief Justice Kant observed.

Senior advocate NHariharan, for petitioners who include students, asked who would register FIRs if the HPEC found police officers liable for the excesses committed on protestors.

Senior advocates Menaka Guruswamy, Gopal Sankaranarayanan and advocate Vrinda Grover flagged the need for a separate hearing by the Supreme Court itself on constitutional questions involving issues like the use of facial recognition surveillance at the Jantar Mantar protest site and the alleged storage of that data with private entities.

Mehta said the committee would have its first meeting on September 15.

Space, semicon among 6 sectors to drive India’s industrial revolution: Jefferies

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Global investment bank Jefferies has highlighted India’s new industrial revolution in six high growth sectors including space and semiconductors.

“Large domestic opportunity is driving participation in emergent industries in India across space, semi & electronics, data centres and solar,” Jefferies said in its report. Further, support from the government is also visible here with actions such as

opening space to private players, tax holidays for data centres, incentive schemes for semiconductors, electronics and solar, localisation measures and government GPU purchases, etc.

SPACE ECONOMY

Talking about space, it said that India is among a handful of spacefaring nations with globally competitive capabilities. The space economy is targeted to grow 5 times to \$40-45 billion by 2030, with private firms such as Skyroot, Pixxel and Agnikul moving towards commercial

execution. On semiconductors, it said that India’s push is moving from policy to execution, with around \$20 billion of investment, a chip fab under construction and several OSAT projects starting production. A further \$13 billion incentive plan is expected to deepen the ecosystem, the report added.

DATA CENTRE BOOM

On data centre, it said that capacity has grown 5 times in five years to 2 GW and is expected to reach 10 GW in the next five years, creating a \$45 billion investment oppor-



tunity across power, cooling, construction and networks. In electronics, “India is moving from assembly towards higher domestic value addition and component manufacturing,” the report said

while expecting domestic value addition in mobile components to rise from below 20 per cent to around 50 per cent over the next 6 years.

In solar, according to the report, India is now the world’s second-largest solar PV manufacturer, with 35 GW of cell capacity operational and another 100 GW under construction. Jefferies expects 90 per cent of the value chain to be localised by 2030.

On aerospace, the report highlighted that India is emerging as a beneficiary of

the global aerospace demand-supply imbalance, supported by cost-competitive manufacturing and engineering talent. Boeing and Airbus already source \$1.4-1.6 billion annually from India, while Indian firms are supplying global OEMs and Tier-1 companies.

The report’s broader point is that India’s large domestic opportunity, rising private participation and government support are driving the expansion of new industries, with growing domestic capacity and global competitiveness.

+ IIHR aims to reduce import dependence on fruits, vegetables

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

The rising import dependence of fruits and vegetables, witnessed in the past few years should start coming down over the next 4-5 years, said Tusar Kanti Behera, Director ICAR-Indian Institute of Horticulture Research (IIHR).

The apex horti research institute is working with around 20-25 such crops that are present in India, but have not been cultivated properly or on a large scale, Behera said.

“We are developing the planting material and strengthening the planting-material supply chain so that these crops can reach farmers. This is particularly important for fruit crops because they require a gestation period of three, four, or even five years before they start producing commercially. Therefore, after another four or five years, imports of these fruits are likely to reduce significantly,” he added.

In value terms, India’s imports of fruits and vegetables has more than doubled from



Tusar Kanti Behera, Director-ICAR-IIHR, Bengaluru

\$1.78 billion in 2016-17 to \$3.82 billion in 2025-26, over the past decade as per the Commerce Ministry data. India’s exports of fruits and vegetables grew 1.46 per cent during 2025-26 over previous year at \$3.93 billion.

GROWING DEMAND

“The imports are increasing because of the growing demand for different crops. At the same time, our exports are also on the rise. Today, people are much more health-conscious and are interested in trying new fruits and vegetables. Many horticultural crops are being imported because they were not traditionally produced in India, but we are emphasising that these crops can

also be cultivated domestically instead of depending on imports,” Behera said.

Citing the example of dragon fruit and avocado, Behera said “dragon fruit was almost 100 per cent imported about five years ago. Today, in most cases, we no longer need to import it, except in certain situations or during particular seasons. We have also developed technologies that allow farmers to cultivate more effectively.”

Other crops for which production technologies have been localised include rambutan, mangosteen and water apple among others, which farmers have started growing in parts of Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh among others, he said. “People knew about avocados to some extent earlier, but now almost everybody wants to consume them, and the demand is increasing rapidly... Two varieties, Arka Supreme and Arka Coorg Ravi, have been developed, and planting material has been supplied to various organisations, particularly in the north-eastern hill regions and eastern India,” he added.

ISRO completes engine tests for LVM3-M7 mission

Press Trust of India
Bengaluru

ISRO on Thursday said it had successfully conducted the flight acceptance hot testing of the cryogenic engine identified for the seventh operational mission of the LVM3 launch vehicle (LVM3-M7), scheduled for the fourth quarter of 2026. The same test demonstrated the performance of a LOX Tank Pressurisation Module designed for the C32 stage, an upgraded cryogenic upper stage planned for India’s Gaganyaan missions, it said.

LVM3, formerly known as GSLV MkIII, is ISRO’s heaviest rocket.

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Bank of India Celebrates 121st Foundation Day, Reaffirms Commitment to Viksit Bharat



Bank of India commemorated its 121st Foundation Day, celebrating over twelve decades of dedicated service, trust, and contribution to India's economic development. Established on September 7, 1906, with a single branch and a small team, the Bank has evolved into one of India's leading public sector banks with a strong domestic and global presence. Today, it serves millions of customers through approximately 37,000 customer touchpoints and a workforce of over 52,000 employees. The Bank marked significant achievements, including Total Global Business surpassing Rs.17.50 lakh crore in Q1 FY27 and annual net profit crossing Rs.10,000 crore in FY26, reflecting its strong financial performance and sustained growth. Addressing the occasion, Managing Director & CEO Shri Rajneesh Karnatak reaffirmed the Bank's commitment to customer-centric banking, technology-driven innovation, financial inclusion, and supporting India's vision of Viksit Bharat. The celebrations included the unveiling of the 121st Foundation Day logo, launch of a new corporate film, and community initiatives such as tree-plantation drives, blood-donation camps, health check-ups, and customer engagement programmes. These activities highlighted Bank of India's enduring commitment to strengthening relationships, empowering communities, and contributing meaningfully to the nation's progress

IIM Jammu Celebrates Ten Years of Excellence, Innovation, and Impact

The Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Jammu celebrated its 10th anniversary on 22 August 2026 at the Mandapam Auditorium, marking a decade of excellence, innovation, institution-building, and societal impact. The day-long celebration brought together distinguished representatives from government, academia, industry, the Board of Governors, faculty, staff, alumni, students, and institutional partners. The inaugural session was graced by Shri Manoj Sinha Ji, Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor of Jammu & Kashmir, as the Chief Guest and was presided over by Dr. Milind P. Kamble, Chairman, Board of Governors, IIM Jammu, in the presence of Shri Shriram S. Dandekar, Former Chairman, Board of Governors, and Prof. B. S. Sahay, Director, IIM Jammu. On the occasion, the Chief Guest released seven coffee table books documenting the Institute's journey, research achievements, library resources, cultural immersion initiatives, and contributions to art and heritage. The valedictory ceremony was graced by Shri Kavinder Gupta Ji, Hon'ble Governor of Himachal Pradesh, as the Chief Guest. Shri Jugal Kishore Sharma Ji, Hon'ble Member of Parliament, and Shri Raj Kumar Chaudhary, Chairman, JERC, attended as distinguished guests. The ceremony was also marked by the presence of Dr. Milind P. Kamble, Chairman, Board of Governors, IIM Jammu, and Prof. B. S. Sahay, Director, IIM Jammu, bringing the memorable celebrations to a fitting conclusion.

Business Initiative

Pendharkar College promotes Startup Culture through Entrepreneurship Awareness Camp in Dombivli



K. V. Pendharkar College of Arts, Science and Commerce (Autonomous) organized the Entrepreneurship Awareness Camp 2026 through its Centre for Research, Innovation and Entrepreneurship to foster a startup ecosystem and nurture entrepreneurial thinking among students. The camp aimed to inspire students to become job creators rather than job seekers, in line with the vision of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020. Industry expert Mr. Niladri Roy, Founder & CEO of Evonix Technologies and Co-Founder of QuicKart, encouraged students to focus on identifying real-world problems, emphasizing that innovation begins with observation. Dr. Ravinder Varma, DGM, Zydrus Wellness Ltd., highlighted the importance of understanding customer needs and validating ideas before launching a startup. Mr. Harshal Lavangare, CEO of Dombivli Shikshan Prasarak Mandal, shared his vision of transforming colleges into innovation hubs that address societal challenges. He also announced upcoming initiatives, including a BARC workshop, an Innovation and Career Festival, and the launch of the college film society, The Bioscope Bugs. The event received an enthusiastic response from students.

Vadnagar Shraavanotsav Draws Over 38,000 Tourists, Showcasing a Unique Blend of Devotion, Culture and Heritage



Gujarat Tourism Corporation's Vadnagar Shraavanotsav, held every Sunday during the holy month of Shraavan at the historic Sharmishtha Lake in Vadnagar, has attracted an overwhelming response from tourists and devotees. Over three Sundays, from August 16 to August 30, a total of 38,119 visitors experienced a vibrant blend of spirituality, culture and heritage. The festival featured Shiva-centric devotional programmes, Vedic rituals, classical music and dance performances, Shiv bhajans, and Gujarat's traditional Hudo Raas, creating a spiritually enriching atmosphere. A major highlight has been the spectacular lighting and light-and-sound show at Sharmishtha Lake, enhancing the heritage setting and evening experience. The final programme will be held on September 6, 2026, featuring devotional and cultural performances along with the popular light-and-sound show. Visitors can also explore Vadnagar's rich heritage, including Hatkeshwar Mahadev Temple, Kirti Toran, Tana-Riri Memorial and other historic attractions.

QUICKLY.

OPEC cuts global oil demand growth forecast



The Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) on Thursday lowered its forecast for world oil demand growth in 2026 to 380,000 barrels per day, a copy of its monthly report showed, marking the fifth straight downward revision. The producer group continues to see a smaller impact on consumption. REUTERS

Copper drifts on US' hesitancy over tariff plan

London: Copper prices fell after Reuters reported the White House is yet to decide on refined copper tariffs. Three month copper on the LME fell 3.1 per cent to \$14,312 a tonne by 1039 GMT. Comex October copper futures slid 4.2 per cent to \$6.5355 per lb, or \$14,408 a tonne, reducing the premium over the LME prices. Aluminium lost 1.5 per cent to \$3,308. REUTERS

Gold slips as US inflation data boost Fed hike bets



Gold prices dropped over one per cent after robust US inflation data increased bets for a Fed rate hike next week. Spot gold slipped 1.2 per cent to \$24,349.32 per ounce by 1324 GMT. US gold futures fell 1.6 per cent to \$4,391.3. Silver slid 4.2 per cent to \$64.47. REUTERS

Govt to track sugar output every month starting Oct

PRICE STABILITY. Mills should sell sugar at reasonable prices, and the government will take corrective measures: Food Ministry Joint Secretary Srivastava

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Asking sugar mills to ensure adequate supplies during the festival season, the government has said that from next season that commences from October, it will track sugar production on a monthly basis to improve policymaking aimed at keeping prices in check. Addressing a conference organised by India Sugar & Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) in New Delhi on Thursday, Ashwini Srivastava, a joint secretary in the Food Ministry said that mills need to sell sugar at reasonable prices, and the government will take corrective measures to keep

prices stable. “We have asked mills to provide accurate monthly production and sugar sale data,” he said. Despite some fall in ex-mill prices in past few days, the retail prices are still at a higher level. On Thursday, the all-India average retail price of sugar was ₹60.2 a kg against ₹60.31 on Wednesday. Wholesale rates were ₹50-100 a quintal, while mill-level prices showed signs of easing, though they ruled between ₹4,700 and ₹5,100 a quintal.

LOWER THAN ESTIMATED OUTPUT
The government last month said that retail sugar prices remained broadly stable, increasing by only around 3 per cent annually between Au-



CROP LOSS. Sugar production during the current season is expected to be around 306 lt, down from the initial estimate of around 343 lt due to Red Rot and Top Borer diseases that hit the crop

gust 2024 and July 2026. The government also said that sugar production during the current season (October 2025-September 2026) is expected to be around 306 lakh tonnes (lt), down from the initial estimate of around 343 lt due to Red Rot and Top Borer diseases that affected

Agri Minister opens another round of consultations on draft Seed Bill

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Thursday launched another round of consultations on the proposed Seed Bill after receiving about 18,000 suggestions in a month. The draft Bill was published in November 2025. With Chouhan non-committal on a deadline to finalise the Bill, industry experts want the process fast-tracked so that the legislation can be introduced at the earliest. Briefing the media after a two-hour meeting with about 20 farmer organisations in New Delhi, Chouhan said the consultation process had only begun and welcomed suggestions from



EARLY PASSAGE. Though the Minister is non-committal on the deadline to finalise the Bill, the industry wants it fast tracked

farmer bodies and individual farmers. He said the government would consider them with an open mind. However, he declined to share any of the suggestions, saying it would not be appropriate to disclose them as they could be interpreted differently. “There is no point in a discussion as all those farmer organisations were also

try to introduce the Bill on the first day of the next session, he said. The draft Seeds Bill, 2025 seeks to regulate the quality of seeds and planting materials available in the market, ensure farmers’ access to high-quality seeds at affordable rates, curb the sale of spurious and poor-quality seeds, protect farmers from losses, liberalise seed imports to promote innovation and access to global varieties, and safeguard farmers’ rights, the Agriculture Ministry had said while inviting feedback. The draft Bill also proposes to decriminalise minor offences to promote ease of doing business and reduce the compliance burden, while retaining stringent provisions to penalise serious violations, it said.

AP’s ‘natural’ farmers tackle low rain season via pre-monsoon dry sowing

KV Kurmanath
Hyderabad

Even as El Nino casts its shadow on the current kharif season, some small farmers in Andhra Pradesh are showing the way to tackle low-rainfall conditions and promote sustainable agricultural practices such as pre-monsoon dry sowing (PMDS) and seed pelleting technology. PMDS involves broadcasting diverse seed varieties during hot summer months to maintain continuous green cover and build soil fertility before the monsoon. Seed pelleting coats seeds in protective natural layers, allowing them to lie dormant in dry soil until rainfall triggers germination without requiring initial soil moisture. “As of September 1, 2026, about 17 lakh farm-

ers have practised PMDS across 7.70 lakh hectares in the State. Of these, about 4.80 lakh farmers have adopted the pelletised mode of seed sowing on 2.11 lakh hectares. As many as 30 crops, including millets, pulses and oilseeds, have been selected for this programme,” said an official of the Rythu Sadhikara Samstha (RySS), a not for profit company set up by the State government. **GREEN COVER** T Vijay Kumar, Executive Vice-Chairman of RySS, said the organisation began developing solutions for rain-fed agriculture after anticipating the El Nino situation in February 2026. He said that over the past four years, RySS has implemented a series of innovations to ensure farmers can grow crops year-round, even in highly unpredictable rain-fed areas.

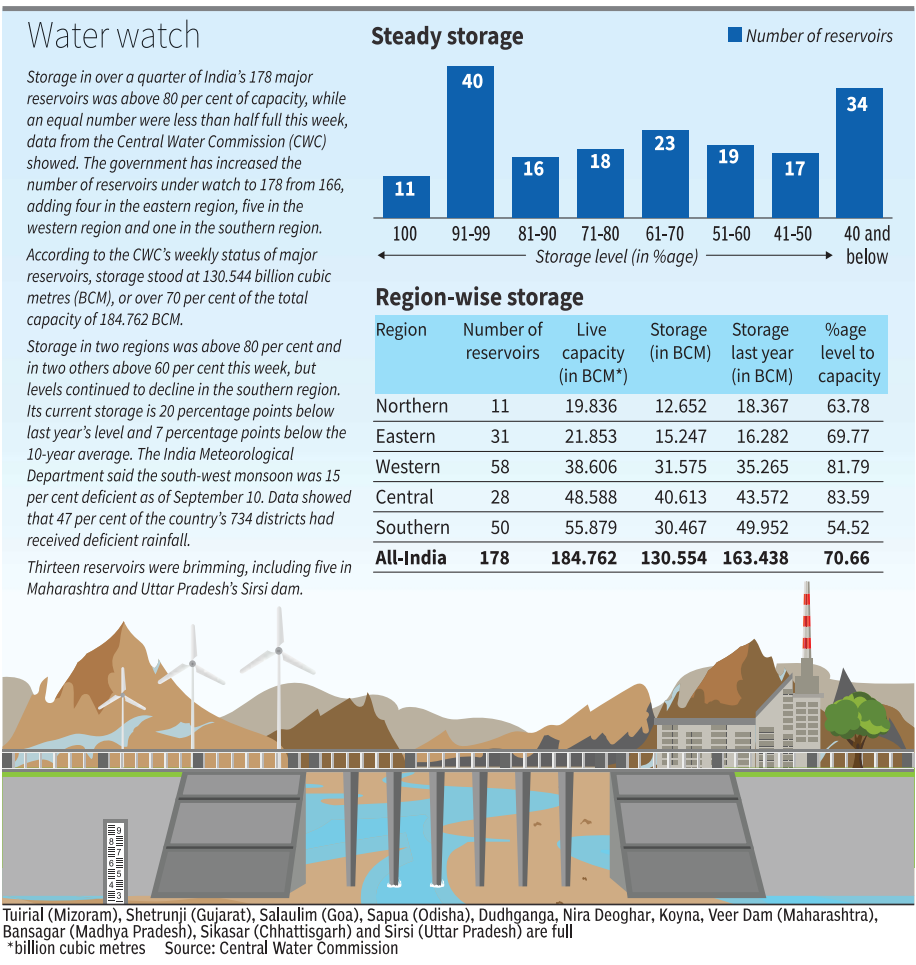
He claimed that this practice ensured a green cover over the soil from March through June, which builds soil fertility, provides farmers with saleable fodder during dry months, and significantly increases yields for the main kharif crop. The official added that it also builds resilience against floods and droughts. “The pelletised seeds survive dry spells and germinate once the rain arrives, saving farmers in dry districts like Anantapur and Kurnool from the financial burden of having to resow multiple times,” he said. While welcoming the government’s promotion of sustainable agricultural practices, which helps build farmer confidence, experts said the actual rollout and implementation would require closer scrutiny to assess its impact.

Campco records ₹47.35 cr net profit in 2025-26, recommends 14% dividend

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Central Arecanut and Cocoa Marketing and Processing Cooperative (Campco) Ltd registered a profit after tax of ₹47.35 crore during 2025-26 and achieved a total business turnover of ₹3,735 crore, despite volatility in the arecanut market and challenging conditions in the cocoa sector, according to SR Satishchandra, President of Campco. Reflecting its continued financial strength and commitment to grower-members, the board of directors of Campco has recommended a 14 per cent dividend for 2025-26, he said. **SUPPORTING FACTORS** Addressing mediapersons in Mangaluru on Thursday, Sat-

ishchandra said the performance was supported by sustained procurement and marketing operations, farmer-oriented initiatives, business diversification, digital transformation and investments in infrastructure and value addition. Terming arecanut as the backbone of Campco, he said the co-operative procured 58,742.76 tonnes of arecanut valued at ₹2,924.32 crore during 2025-26. This included 24,052.07 tonnes of red arecanut and 34,690.69 tonnes of white arecanut. The co-operative sold 59,088.64 tonnes of arecanut valued at ₹2,985.19 crore, comprising 22,914.53 tonnes of red arecanut and 36,174.11 tonnes of white arecanut. During the year, Campco exported 130 tonnes of premium Indian arecanut to Maldives.



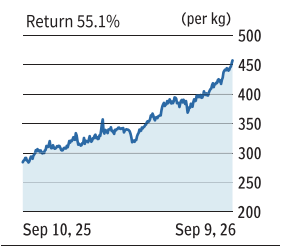
Go long on zinc futures

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures (₹427/kg) continued to move up and hit a record high of ₹429.95 on Thursday. The upward momentum appears strong and further gains are highly likely.

COMMODITY CALL.

The September futures have been consolidating between ₹410 and ₹422 recently. But early this week, the contract broke out of ₹422 and rallied. After marking a high of ₹429.95, it is now hovering around ₹427. As the uptrend is intact, the contract is likely to gain more in the coming sessions, possibly to ₹440, a potential resistance. A breakout of this can lift zinc futures to ₹450.



However, if there is a decline from the current level, it can retest the resistance-turned-support of ₹422. A breach of this can drag the contract lower to ₹412, its 21-day moving average. Overall, from a trading perspective, participants can consider long positions. **TRADE STRATEGY** Buy zinc futures if the price dips to ₹422. Place stop-loss at ₹410. When the contract rises to ₹432, tighten the stop-loss to ₹425. Book profits at ₹440.

Mitti Labs in 5-year deal with Google to scale climate smart rice farming in India

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Deep-tech company Mitti Labs has announced a five-year carbon credit arrangement with Google to scale climate-smart agriculture across 1 lakh hectares of smallholder rice farms in India. The announcement follows Mitti Labs' recent \$9.5-million funding round, which the company said reflects growing momentum around agriculture as a climate solution. The partnership aims to transition more than 70,000 farmers to water- and methane-saving irrigation practices, potentially eliminating 3 million tonnes of near-term warming impact (GWP20), equivalent to 1 million tonnes

of GWP100 impact, while conserving billions of gallons of water across critical regional basins. “Google is committed to finding the most promising solutions that neutralise warming across both the near and long term. Mitti Labs’ approach delivers critical near-term atmospheric impact by cutting methane emissions, while conserving billions of gallons of water and empowering smallholder farmers to deploy advanced water-management practices. We’re excited to partner with them to help accelerate and scale their solution across India,” said Kate Brandt, chief sustainability officer at Google. Rice paddies, which are traditionally kept continuously flooded, are among the largest

human-induced sources of methane, accounting for more than 10 per cent of global methane emissions. Mitti Labs combines engagement with farming communities and satellite radar technology to promote alternate irrigation practices. The company said the shift can cut methane emissions from rice fields by up to 50 per cent and reduce irrigation volumes by nearly 40 per cent, while maintaining yields. **WATER SAVINGS** The partnership is projected to save billions of litres of water across the country — equivalent to Bengaluru’s annual water supply for three years, according to the company. It also aims to demonstrate the use of satellite technology to

promote water-efficient rice farming practices. Mitti Labs’ GeoAI platform, developed with support from NASA, combines high-resolution satellite radar data with field-collected ground data to generate field-level insights on crop health, soil moisture and flooding across individual smallholder plots. “Reducing methane from rice farming is one of the most powerful levers we have to slow near-term warming. This partnership is a powerful accelerator of our mission to reduce emissions, save water, and strengthen the livelihoods of the 150 million smallholder farmers who grow one of the world’s most important food crops,” said Xavier Laguarta, co-founder of Mitti Labs.

Arabica coffee hits 10-week low; sugar slips

Reuters
London

Arabica coffee futures slid to a 10-week low on Thursday, weighed partly by a favourable outlook for next year’s crop in top producer Brazil, while sugar prices edged lower. Arabica coffee fell 2.7 per cent to \$2.8415 per lb by 1405GMT, after setting a 10-week low of \$2.8210. Dealers said this year’s harvest in Brazil is now nearly complete and the focus was switching to prospects for the 2027 crop. Robusta coffee fell 0.7 per cent to \$3.448 a tonne. **SUGAR DOWN** Raw sugar slipped 0.4 per cent to 18.33 cents/lb. Deal-



ers said the run-up has been driven by tight supplies in top consumer India and the current strength of energy markets. White sugar fell 0.6 per cent to \$531.20 a tonne. **COCOA TUMBLES** London cocoa fell one per cent to £4,280 a tonne, while New York cocoa fell 1.1 per cent to \$5,885 a tonne.

QUICKLY.

Banking services likely to be hit due to strike today

New Delhi: Banking services like cash withdrawals and deposits at public sector banks may be impacted today as unions have decided to go on strike to press for five-day banking and other pending demands. With the strike, banking services, especially in public sector banks, will be impacted for four days in many parts of the country. September 11 is a Friday, and the subsequent two days are bank holidays. September 14 is a holiday in some States for Ganesh Chaturthi. **PI**

TN CM Vijay begins UK investment mission

Chennai: A delegation led by Tamil Nadu CM C Joseph Vijay is visiting the UK from September 10-17. The agenda includes a visit to the Silverstone Motor Racing Circuit to build on Tamil Nadu's automobile and EV manufacturing ecosystem and the State's decision to build a world-class 'Motor Sports City'. The details of other meetings on the agenda were not disclosed. **OUR BUREAU**

10 districts in UP, 3 States lead in number of informal ventures: NSO

KEY INSIGHTS. First-ever district-level estimates reveal concentration and women entrepreneurship patterns

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Uttar Pradesh, along with Telangana, Gujarat, and West Bengal, boasts the top 10 districts in terms of unincorporated establishments, according to the first-ever district-level estimates for the unincorporated non-agricultural sector released by the National Statistical Office (NSO), on Thursday.

While West Bengal's North Twenty-Four Parganas leads the tally with around 16 lakh establishments, Uttar Pradesh's Prayagraj has over 6 lakh units.

The report draws upon data from the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE). This marks the first initiative of the NSO to disseminate district-level estimates from a large-scale, nationwide survey.

The report covers 757 of 770 districts. Establishments in the unincorporated



HIDDEN HUBS. One-third of districts have more than one lakh informal enterprises each, says the report

non-agricultural sector refer to small, informal businesses or enterprises outside the farming sector that are not registered under any law, such as the Companies Act.

TOP DISTRICT

According to the report, the top 10 districts, ranked by the estimated number of unincorporated establishments, together account for about one-tenth of the total establishments, workers, and Gross Value Added (GVA) generated by the sector. Meanwhile, the top 50

districts capture nearly one-third of the total establishments, workforce, and GVA. The top 10 districts are spread across four States: Gujarat, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, and West Bengal, while the top 50 districts are spread across 12 States: Bihar, Gujarat, Karnataka, Kerala, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, and West Bengal.

Roughly one-third of all districts have more than one lakh unincorporated establishments per district, while

about 9 per cent of the districts have fewer than 10,000. Only 16 districts (from West Bengal, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Telangana, and Uttar Pradesh) have more than 5 lakh unincorporated establishments each. District-level estimates also highlight variations in the productivity performance of the unincorporated sector.

In approximately 331 districts, the GVA per worker is estimated to be between ₹1 and ₹1.5 lakh. In 280 districts, the GVA per worker exceeds the all-India average (₹1.56 lakh).

WOMEN-LED BIZ

The district-level estimates reveal significant regional patterns in female entrepreneurship. The top 10 districts with the highest share of female-led establishments are in Telangana, Manipur, and Meghalaya. In Mizoram, female-owned proprietary establishments account for at least 50 per cent of estab-

lishments in each district of the State. A similar pattern is observed in the participation of women in the workforce.

The top 10 districts with the highest share of female workers are in Telangana, Manipur, Meghalaya, and Mizoram, reflecting the significant role played by women in the unincorporated sector in these States. In as many as 237 districts, women constitute one-third of the total workforce in the unincorporated sector, whereas in 25 districts, female workers make up more than 50 per cent of the workforce.

According to Geeta Singh Rathore, Director General of the National Sample Survey, the report provides a balanced set of operational and economic indicators covering the size, employment characteristics, enterprise profiles, and selected measures of economic performance for the districts with rural and urban sectors combined.

Mukesh Ambani calls on firms to enable women to retain jobs, rise as leaders

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



Mukesh Ambani, Chairman, Reliance Industries, at a book launch at the BSE **REUTERS**

Reliance Industries Chairman and Managing Director Mukesh Ambani on Thursday called on corporate leaders to collectively build an ecosystem that enables more working women and mothers to remain in employment and rise to leadership roles, warning that India Inc still has "a very long way to go" in ensuring women receive the opportunities they deserve.

WOMEN LEADERS

Speaking at the BSE during the launch of *Aparajita*, the Hindi edition of former State Bank of India Chairperson Arundhati Bhattacharya's memoir, *Indomitable*, Ambani stated that the Reliance Foundation would participate fully in such an initiative.

He asked Bhattacharya and other accomplished women leaders to help lead it.

"Let us collectively start an effective initiative to strengthen the ecosystem that supports working women and working mothers in corporate India," Ambani said. "You take the leadership; we will follow."

The appeal gave the book launch a wider corporate purpose. Bhattacharya's four-decade journey, from joining SBI as a probationary officer to becoming the bank's first woman chairperson and later leading Salesforce India, has come to represent both the possibilities available to women and the structural barriers they continue to encounter.

Ambani said the Hindi edition would carry her story to "the young women and men of Bharat" across cities, towns, districts and villages. That reach is important as businesses recruit more deeply from tier-II and -III India and a generation of

first-time professionals attempts to navigate institutions historically shaped by metropolitan and English-speaking networks.

"Women are no longer merely beneficiaries of progress; they are its architects," he said, pointing to their growing leadership across business, science, sport, the armed forces and communities. "When the women of India rise, India rises. And when the women of India become unstoppable, India becomes unstoppable."

'EMOTIONAL QUOTIENT'

Bhattacharya has served as an independent director on the Reliance Industries board since 2018. Ambani described her as an independent-minded strategic thinker and problem-solver who listens patiently, challenges constructively and looks beyond immediate difficulties to their longer-term consequences.

He also credited her with consistently pushing Reliance to treat diversity as a source of stronger leadership and better decision-making. The company, he said, now has many more women in senior roles.

"The world needs more emotional quotient than intellectual quotient, which is to say, more women in leadership positions," Ambani said.

Delhi HC mandates biometric Aadhaar authentication for GST registration

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Taking note of the large number of fraudulent GST registrations, the Delhi High Court has directed GST authorities across the country not to allow GST Registration without biometric-based Aadhaar authentication. It has also urged the tax administration to examine the 10 points suggested by Senior Advocate Tarun Gulati to check fake registration.

In an interim order of September 8, a division

bench of Justices Anil Kshetarpal and Shail Jain, said that it is compelled to request the competent authorities to rise to the situation, which has resulted in loss of revenue to the government and harassment of innocents.

IDENTITY CHECK

Further, it noted that lawyers of the tax department had failed to draw attention to any difficulty in mandating biometric-based Aadhaar authentication of GST registration.

Hence, "for the time being, directions are issued to

authorities across the country not to allow any GST registration without biometric-based Aadhaar authentication henceforth," it said.

Further, the authorities can file any practical difficulty in the implementation.

The bench highlighted answers given by the Minister of State in the Finance Ministry on the floor of the Rajya Sabha, where it was said that in 2023-2024, there were 2,800 fraudulent GST registrations, and detection of ₹15,085 crore of tax evasion. Similarly, in 2024-



2025, the number of fraudulent GST registrations stood at 1,654 with ₹13,109 crore of tax evasion.

IMPLEMENTATION LAPSE

"It appears that despite passage of more than one year, the statement given by the

minister on the floor of the House has not been fully implemented, resulting in continuous fake GST registration obtained using stolen or frozen PAN/ Aadhaar details," the bench said. It also hoped that the authorities would examine the suggestions given by Tarun Gulati, Senior Advocate.

Some of the suggestions by Gulati include, mandatory facial recognition of the applicant with the Aadhaar database for all registrations; video-based verification of the PAN and Aadhaar with the applicants face on the camera holding each

document for a minimum of 5 seconds; the IP address and device location used at the time of filing the application should be preserved by the GST common portal as well as the jurisdictional authority sanctioning the application and granting registration; and mandatory physical verification of the proposed principal place of business should be undertaken by the GST Department; real time sharing of data with the Income Tax department, with a message and email to the applicant that the detail has been used for GST registration.

Decathlon India sees gifting, corporate wellness driving B2B segment growth

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru



KEY DRIVERS. Decathlon is also seeing opportunities beyond metro cities, where resellers, retailers and smaller government organisations are driving demand

Decathlon India's B2B business has grown 20 times over the past five years and now accounts for around 10 per cent of the sports retailer's India revenue, as rising interest in sports and wellness opens up demand beyond its stores and e-commerce channels.

The company, which entered the B2B segment in 2018, currently works with around 20,000 partners across the country and plans to double that base to about 40,000 over the next three-four years, said Raghendra Singh, Wholesale Director, Decathlon Sports India.

The B2B business spans corporates and small enterprises, schools and institutions, resellers and retailers and government and defence requirements. The

company is also present on the Government e-Marketplace and other government channels.

CORPORATE GIFTING

One of the emerging areas is corporate gifting, where companies are increasingly moving beyond conventional electronics and utility products to sport and well-

ness products. Employee induction kits are also seeing demand for sporting gear, while gift cards allow employees to choose products based on their interests.

"Gifting becomes a prominent vertical for us during the festive season," Singh said, adding that it is expected to account for more than 25 per cent of revenue dur-

ing the September-New Year period. Decathlon is also seeing opportunities beyond metro cities, where resellers, retailers and smaller government organisations are driving demand.

LOCAL PRODUCTION

On local manufacturing, Singh said that a big chunk sold by Decathlon in India is made locally, including products customised for specific B2B clients.

The company expects its B2B business to grow in line with the broader sports market, rather than targeting a specific future revenue share. Singh said increasing grassroots participation, the growth of running and other sports communities, and initiatives such as Khelo India could further expand the market.

"The next revolution could be a sports revolution in India," he said.

'New-age economy to nearly triple to \$300 billion in revenue by FY31'

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



India's new-age economy is expected to nearly triple to around \$300 billion in revenue by FY31 from about \$100 billion in FY26, approaching the scale of India's IT services sector, according to a report by Redseer Strategy Consultants.

New-age economy companies are digitally native businesses or companies that use technology as a core part of their business model, unlike traditional businesses where digital is primarily a secondary channel, the report said.

GROWTH SHIFT

The sector is expected to grow at around 25 per cent annually between FY26 and FY31, compared with 32 per cent seen between FY22 and FY26. Emerging technology-led sectors, including tech-

nology, media and telecom (TMT), artificial intelligence and manufacturing, are projected to grow slightly faster at around 26 per cent annually, increasing their share of the new-age economy from about 31-33 per cent.

Consumption-led sectors, such as consumer goods, retail and leisure, are expected to remain the anchor, growing at around 25 per cent annually to reach about \$150 billion by FY31.

PROFIT SWING

The report also highlights a

sharp improvement in profitability. Combined EBITDA of new-age companies swung from a \$4.8 billion loss in FY23 to a \$1.4 billion profit in FY25. However, the profitability remains concentrated in banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI), which accounted for around 140 per cent of the overall FY25 profit pool.

Excluding BFSI, all other sectors combined remained loss-making.

PROFITABILITY GAP

Despite the projected revenue expansion, Redseer estimates that the new-age economy could generate only \$5-10 billion in profit by FY31, translating to a margin of 2-3 per cent.

This compares with margins of 12-18 per cent for listed FMCG companies and 20-25 per cent for IT services, indicating that scale alone may not lead to proportionate profitability."

IRCTC hotels case: Delhi court frames charges against Lalu, 8 others

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

A Delhi court on Thursday ordered framing of money laundering charges against former railway minister Lalu Prasad Yadav, his wife Rabri Devi, son Tejashwi Yadav and six others in the Enforcement Directorate's case regarding the alleged IRCTC hotel scam. Of 16 accused, Special Judge Vishal Gogne discharged seven and framed charges against nine.

Pronouncing the substantive portions of the order, the Judge said the exacting standards of finding the criminal intent or *mens rea* was not needed at the present stage and the court had to only see whether there is a strong suspicion against the accused. The court has already framed charges against the RJD patriarch and 11 others last October in the CBI case in the alleged scam.

Raana Semiconductors to launch CZ ingot machine

Rohan Das
Chennai

Raana Semiconductors, a Chennai-based deep tech start-up that builds equipment for the conversion of pure silicon into ingots, is gearing up to launch its first commercial-grade 12-inch CZ single-crystal machine in the next 10-12 months.

Speaking to *businessline*, Founder and CEO Rajasekar Elavarasan said that Raana Semiconductors' first range of 12-inch CZ machines will be built for solar module manufacturers. "We are hoping to manufacture and supply a capacity of machines that can support cell production of roughly 10 GW in the next three years," he said. CZ refers to Czochralski method, a popular process through which pure silicon is

converted into single-crystal ingots, which can then be sliced into silicon wafers used in chips, solar cells, sensors, and other applications.

Elavarasan said that the firm is currently in the process of securing an order for around 2 GWs of machine capacity from a major solar manufacturer, which, if secured, could push topline to around ₹300 crore by FY28.

It is also working on setting up a 40,000 sq ft facility in Hosur for the making of CZ machines. Elavarasan says Raana's machines are about 70 per cent localised.

"For semiconductors, we want to supply only the wafers and not the machine. We want to hold the entire IP in terms of ingot and wafer manufacturing. But for solar, we are going to sell the machines," he said.

Telangana mulls floating solar power projects on reservoirs to augment generation capacity

Our Bureau
Hyderabad



Despite the additional costs, the State government is making efforts to encourage investors and take the sector forward

As peak power demand in Telangana surged to 18,543 MW from 15,000 MW in December 2023, the State government has plans to promote floating solar power and other non-conventional energy sources. Deputy Chief Minister and Energy Minister Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka said the government is considering to set up floating solar plants on irrigation reservoirs across the State.

FUNDING CHALLENGES

Addressing the Assembly on Thursday, he said the Energy and Irrigation departments were jointly studying the possibility and the govern-

ment would decide soon.

Responding to questions raised by members during Question Hour, he said the government is considering floating solar plants on the Nagarjuna Sagar, Srisailem, Pulichintala, Sri Ram Sagar, and Sripada Yellampalli reservoirs.

Bhatti Vikramarka said floating solar projects involve higher costs compared

with conventional solar projects and there were difficulties despite the ₹1 crore per MW Viability Gap Funding (VGF) the Centre has assured.

"The Centre's condition that domestically manufactured equipment must be used would cause an additional burden of about ₹1.30 crore per MW, he explained. Relaxation of conditions like

these would encourage greater interest among investors in floating solar projects," he observed.

Despite the additional costs, the State government was making efforts to encourage investors and take the floating solar sector forward, he said.

"Industrial growth and an increase in people's purchasing power drove the rise in electricity demand. While the growing demand was a positive sign of the State's development, there was also a need to strengthen power generation and distribution systems in line with the increasing requirement," he said. The government provides an annual subsidy of about ₹14,000 crore for free agricultural power, Bhatti Vikramarka said.

Tata Steel commissions first coke oven gas injection project

Press Trust of India
Bhubaneswar

In a first-of-its-kind initiative in the country's steel industry, Tata Steel has commissioned a coke oven gas injection project at the blast furnace in its Meramandali plant in Odisha.

"This initiative reinforces Tata Steel's leadership in sustainable manufacturing. We remain focused on demonstrating and scaling low-carbon technologies, thereby accelerating our journey

towards Net Zero by 2045," said Subodh Pandey, Vice President - Technology, R&D.

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thehindu **businessline.**

KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice

Tender No : 14/2026-27/KWA/PHC/TVLA 1) Jal Jeevan Mission: WSS to Mylapra, Malayalappuzha and Vadasserikkrara Pts - Construction of 1.5LL GLSR at Mylapra Panchayath (Valaythi) including supply and Laying 200mm DI pipes - General Civil Work. EMD : Rs. 100000, Tender fee : Rs. 9759, Last Date for submitting Tender : 22-09-2026 02:00:pm, Phone : 8281597974, Website : www.kwa.kerala.gov.in, www.etenders.kerala.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
PH Circle, Pathanamthitta

KWA-JB-GL-6-274-2026-27

QUICKLY.

Emirates SkyCargo adds
freighter flights in India



Mumbai: Emirates SkyCargo has introduced new weekly freighter services to Bengaluru, Chennai and Hyderabad to support growth in Indian exports, it said on Thursday. The addition increases Emirates’ freighter flights to India to seven per week. “We are enabling Indian exporters to connect quickly and efficiently with international customers by providing rapid and reliable access to global supply chains,” said Badr Abbas, Divisional Senior Vice-President, Emirates SkyCargo. In FY26, Emirates SkyCargo transported over 153,000 tonnes of goods from India. Major export commodities transported by the carrier include pharmaceuticals, perishables, high-tech electronics, engineering and automotive components as well as fashion goods. **OUR BUREAU**

IndiGo to launch daily
Dar es Salaam flights

New Delhi: Airline major IndiGo will launch daily direct flights between Mumbai and Dar es Salaam in Tanzania from November 20, expanding its international network and connectivity to Africa. According to the airline, the service will make it the only Indian carrier to offer direct connectivity between Mumbai and Dar es Salaam. IndiGo said that the bookings are open through its website, mobile app and authorised travel partners. The new route will add to IndiGo’s existing direct services from India to Nairobi, Mauritius and Seychelles. Besides, the airline expects the service to facilitate trade, investment, tourism and educational exchanges between India and East Africa. **OUR BUREAU**

SC questions FSSAI on thresholds for ‘high’ sugar, salt, fat warnings

REGULATORY PIVOT. The court’s inquiry reflects concern over food standards in relation to children’s health

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Thursday questioned the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on how it proposed to determine whether packaged foods were ‘high’ in sugar, salt or fat as part of its proposed front-of-pack warning labels, as it underlined that food safety was a cause of ‘national interest’.

The FSSAI had last month proposed prominent red warning labels on packaged foods high in added fat, added sugar or salt, marking a regulatory pivot after the top court questioned its reluctance to introduce such warnings.

In an affidavit filed before the court, the food regulator said the labels would take the form of a red hexagonal warning on the front of packages where a product was found to be high in two or more specified nutrients of concern — fat, sugar or salt.

The thresholds would be based on those prescribed under the Dietary Guidelines



NATIONAL INTEREST. The court emphasised the importance of food safety and urged the regulator to adopt clear guidelines

for Indians, 2024, issued by the ICMR-National Institute of Nutrition (NIN). A Bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran, while examining the FSSAI’s affidavit, however, questioned how the regulator would determine the threshold beyond which a packaged food would be classified as “high” in sugar, salt or fat.

GUIDELINES QUERY

“If you ask them to put a label, say high in salt, high in sugar, high in sodium, high in potassium, how will you determine it? Have you laid down any guidelines?” the Bench asked.

Additional Solicitor General Brijender Chahar, ap-

pearing for the Centre and the FSSAI, said the regulator was adhering to the guidelines issued by the ICMR-NIN.

The Bench was hearing a public interest litigation filed by non-profit organisations 3S and Our Health seeking warning labels on packaged foods to indicate high levels of salt, sugar and saturated fats. On Thursday, it indicated that it would soon pass a detailed order seeking further information from the stakeholders.

“We have done some homework and undertaken some study. We propose to pass an order calling for some further information from you. Study the order

and come back with an appropriate further report,” Justice Pardiwala told Chahar. The top court also asked the regulator to take its directions “seriously”, stressing its concern over the impact of food safety standards on public health, particularly that of growing children.

“We are concerned with the health of people, more particularly growing children. We have taken it up very seriously... We expect one and all to extend cooperation in a cause which is in national interest,” Justice Pardiwala said.

‘TWO-PHASE ROLLOUT’

The FSSAI had told the court that it intended to introduce the front-of-pack nutrition labelling (FoPNL) system in two phases to give consumers time to adapt to the new labels and the food industry time to reformulate its products. Under the first phase, the warning would apply to products high in two or more of the three specified nutrients, added fat, added sugar and salt, besides certain sweetened beverages.

The second phase would extend it to products high in even one of these nutrients.

The Bench, however, questioned why a product would initially have to be high in more than one nutrient to attract the warning.

“It has to be sugar and salt. Only then will you ask them to put a label?” Justice Pardiwala asked.

Taking the court’s suggestion into account, Chahar told the Bench that the regulator could consider introducing the warning labels “in one go”, rather than in two phases.

This would effectively bring products high in even one of the three nutrients within the warning-label regime from the outset.

Senior advocate Devadatt Kamat, appearing for an intervenor, argued that ultra-processed foods could not be placed on the same footing as other packaged foods, citing the example of snacks such as Kurkure on the one hand and eggs or salted cashews on the other. He urged the court to consider a more prominent warning for ultra-processed products.

New pilot dope-testing guidelines likely by month-end: Minister

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Centre hopes to finalise new guidelines on dope testing of pilots by the end of this month, said Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu.

Besides, sources told *businessline* the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has directed all airline operators to conduct a one-time dope-testing exercise covering all their pilots during the period from August 1, 2026, to July 31, 2027.

Speaking at an event here on Thursday, Naidu said that the DGCA is continuing its discussions with stakeholders on the draft civil aviation requirement (CAR).

Asked about possible action against the pilot-in-command (PIC) involved in the Air India AI2379 altitude-upset incident, Naidu said the DGCA would have to take action. However, he indicated that the CAR should come out before deciding the nature of action.

“Let us go ahead with the CAR and later we can decide,” he said.

AVIATION SAFETY

The DGCA is said to be considering 100 per cent annual dope testing of pilots as part of efforts to strengthen aviation safety.

According to the Minister’s remarks last month, the existing rules provide for testing of 10 per cent of pilots across the overall pilot network.

The proposed approach would require every pilot to undergo a test at a random time during the year.

However, the Minister had said the proposal would need to balance safety concerns with the operational impact on airlines, with the DGCA assessing the implications in consultation with stakeholders. Furthermore, sources



Embraer’s Global Head of Government Relations Jose Serrador Neto felicitates Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu during a meeting in New Delhi on Thursday **ANI**

said testing is underway ahead of the revised CAR, with airlines directed to complete the exercise within the stipulated timeframe.

AIR INDIA INCIDENT

Additionally, sources said the Air India Group is voluntarily conducting screening tests of all its pilots following the psychoactive-substance finding involving the PIC of the Phuket-Delhi flight.

The developments come days after an official preliminary report into the AI2379 incident flagged multiple issues, including the loss of all three hydraulic systems during cruise, brief disengagement of the autopilot and a ‘non-negative’ psychoactive-substance test involving the PIC. Notably, the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) report did not establish any link between the psychoactive-substance finding and the altitude upset.

However, the AAIB described the confirmation of psychoactive substance use as a “serious concern” and recommended appropriate action by the DGCA on priority to prevent abuse of such substances.

Following the report, Air India terminated the PIC’s employment with immediate effect, citing its zero-tolerance approach to violations of safety, fitness, or regulatory requirements.

Trump woos voters with \$5,000 payout offer

Reuters
Dallas

US President Donald Trump capped the first day of his Republican Party’s first-ever mid-term convention by proposing to pay every US adult a \$5,000 “Trump dividend” if his party wins November’s congressional elections.

Trump delivered the extraordinary overture during a primetime speech that lasted nearly two hours and firmly placed him at the

centre of the mid-term campaign at a time when his sagging approval ratings could weigh on Republicans’ chances. Vice-President JD Vance will give the keynote address, though Trump is scheduled to make closing remarks to bring the made-for-television two-day event in Dallasto an end.

With Trump constitutionally barred from seeking a third term, Vance’s speech could serve as an early audition for the 2028 presidential election and offer clues



US President Donald Trump

about how he would lead a party reshaped by Trump. It was not immediately clear how the \$5,000 payments

would work or whether they would be legal. The proposal would likely cost more than \$1 trillion, with approximately 270 million US adults, and could require the approval of Congress.

CRITICAL SWING

But it remains to be seen whether his campaign-style speech will appeal to the critical swing voters who have drifted away from Trump’s party amid growing dissatisfaction with the cost of living and the war on Iran. “I’m ask-

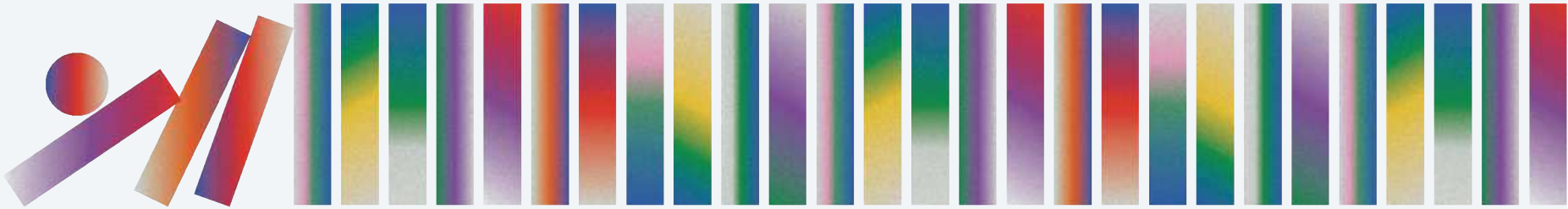
ing you to pretend that I’m on the ballot,” Trump said.

Some vulnerable Republicans in tough races, perhaps mindful of tying themselves too closely to the unpopular Trump, elected to skip the affair.

Alabama state Representative Ernie Yarbrough, a convention attendee, said Trump needs to give voters a clearer sense of how long the war in Iran could last.

“People want to feel like we’re not getting stuck in an endless cycle,” he said.

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